THE CONDEMNED

De Caserta finished scribbling his signature on a stack of orders and looked up. He saw that his five victims were already lined up against the far wall in front of his bookcase.

"Ah!" he said. "Excellent! The warden's men are prompt! This is good. We have little time to wa…."

The big one, Dorgrim, surged across the room, hands outstretched. The muscles in his huge arms already straining, muscles like unleashed hounds bulged.

Then a flash from the collar at his neck and the smell of sulfur and burnt flesh. Dorgrim fell to the ground, his whole body seized with pain.

"Oh good," de Caserta said, obviously relieved. "Thank you for saving me the whole…," he waved a hand, "speech thing. A demonstration is much more effective, you're absolutely right." The others tried to help Dorgrim up, but once he had his feet under him he bucked them off. Gave de Caserta a sullen, feral look, and took a few steps back.

"Oh I didn't mean to discourage you! By all means try your best. I mean, either the collars work or they don't and if they don't, better to find out now!"

The five prisoners seemed cowed. Wary.

"No?" de Caserta asked, hopefully. He looked at the pale woman. "Solis? You do not wish to…test your powers?"

The revenant sneered but said nothing. De Caserta sat in the plush leather chair. "I agree," he said. "Waste of time. Let's get on with it.

"Now. Before we get to your real mission, I thought perhaps an aperitif. Drinks before dinner, that style of thing." None of them appeared to appreciate his clever phrasing. Ah well, he thought, they aren't Riojan.

He moved some clutter from the desk revealing an architect's diagram of a building. "These are the floorplans for the abbey of Saint Iphicrates here in the Stays. Somewhere in this building, possibly under guard, is this man, Count Gerold Artigern. This is a very naughty boy, our man Gerold. He uses a teleporter pad in the abbey to ferry our secrets to Lord Ajax.

"In," de Caserta looked at his expensive pocketwatch, "a little less than an hour, Gerold will have escaped from our clutches and will be meeting with Ajax, sharing who knows which of our stolen state secrets."

He looked meaningfully at the five collared prisoners. "But there will be no meeting," he said. "Because in one hour? Gerold will be here. Brought here by you. Dead or alive. Also, I require his private journal.

"The abbey's people will try to stop you, but some subtlety or subterfuge may be effective? I have long suspected the abbot of Saint Iphicrates is sympathetic to Ajax, but I've never been able to prove it. Alas, I fear he is merely impressed with Count Artigern's noble pedigree, being himself from County Artigern, and is little more than a political crawler, happy to impress anyone with power. Which I must overlook, or I would be forced to arrest half the city!"

No one laughed. He looked at his new agents again, registering each of them.

"Get in, get Gerold, and get out. This is a simple task, I am providing you the intel," he said gesturing to the diagram of the cathedral, "and however capable Gerold is, he is only one man. And not, ah…as well motivated as you five."

He sat back in his chair, relaxed again.

"Any questions?"

The Condemned is an adventure for the *Draw Steel* roleplaying game. It's intended for four to seven players, including the Director.

In *The Condemned*, the protagonists are prisoners offered a chance at freedom if they pull off a dangerous mission. This adventure can feature morally gray or even downright evil protagonists. Before you begin, make sure that everyone is on board with this type of adventure!

This adventure assumes that most, if not all, players have moderate experience with the *Draw Steel* system. Furthermore, these pages are intended for the Director's eyes only. If you don't plan on being the director for this game, **stop reading now!**

Sidebar: Content Warning

In this adventure, the protagonists are condemned criminals unwillingly infilitrating an evil city. It touches on a number of potentially sensitive themes, tropes, and challenges that should be discussed with everyone before you play:

- Evil characters
- Execution
- Coercion
- Body horror
- Body and organ harvesting

Adventure Background

Ajax the Invincible is a mighty human warlord who has ascended to power on the back of great military victories and even greater ambitions. Ajax's armies have swept over Vasloria and stand at the borders of Higara. Ruling from his flying city, the Crysopolis, Ajax intends to bring the entire world under his dominion.

An obstacle lies across his path: Capital, the Greatest City in This or Any Age. Capital is a nut that Ajax hasn't been able to crack. Capital's walls are strong, and its militia is vast by city standards, but none of that would be much of an obstacle if it weren't for Capital's fearsome blackpowder cannons and bombs.

Recently, the tide of the war changed when Ajax's spies seized a military asset from Capital: one that may help Ajax unlock the secret of blackpowder for himself. Armed with this technology, Ajax's conquest of the world would be only a matter of time.

Adventure Synopsis

The adventure's protagonists are the Condemned: criminals from the Cauldron, Capital's toughest prison. They're brought together by Ottavio de Caserta, the spymaster of House Vorona. He's chosen them for an important mission: infiltrate Ajax's flying city, the Crysopolis, and steal back the asset that may allow Ajax to create blackpowder. It's a slim chance, but it may be the world's only one.

De Caserta has handpicked the Condemned for two reasons. First, they all have exceptional skills—skills that landed them in the section of the Cauldron reserved for the most dangerous inmates. Second, they are all sentenced to death. If they succeed on the mission, they'll be pardoned. That's the carrot.

Although they're each skilled in their own way, the Condemned aren't exactly known for following orders. That's why de Caserta has fitted them each with a "loyalty collar:" an unremovable metal collar that explodes if its wearer disobeys de Caserta. That's the stick.

This adventure is broken into three parts:

Part 1: The Condemned must capture Ajax's spy, Gerold, who is holed up in an abbey in Capital. Besides being a dangerous enemy agent, Gerold has the password that will let the team teleport to the Crysopolis.

Part 2: The Condemned explore the Crysopolis, searching for the location of the stolen asset. They'll need to make connections and track down leads, all while avoiding war dog patrols.

Part 3: Having learned the location of the stolen asset, the Condemned must break into a heavily-guarded facility, extract the asset, and find an escape route. To escape, the Condemned must

commandeer a flying ship and fight their way through waves of enemy air fighters.

Notable NPCs

Ottavio de Caserta: The spymaster of Capital's noble House Vorona and the creator of the Condemned program. Engaged in an espionage war with Ajax's better-equipped and better-funded spy network, he must use unorthodox methods if Capital is to stand a chance.

Gerold: A spy for Ajax assigned to Capital, Gerold captured Lady Letitia de Toera and is now engaged in further acts of espionage. He uses a teleportation pad hidden in Capital's Abbey of Saint Iphicrates to communicate with Ajax.

Over the course of the adventure Gerold is captured or killed, turned into a disembodied head that guides the heroes, and then ultimately becomes a war dog abomination that pursues them.

Khavettra: A harbormaster for the Chrysopolis, Khavettra is a memonek member of UNISOL on loan to Ajax's forces. He has joined a dissident group on the Chrysopolis, disillusioned with Ajax's actions. He reaches out to the heroes to help them complete their mission.

Lady Letitia de Toera: A minor noble in House Vorona, Lady Letitia is a brilliant alchemist and the inventor of blackpowder. She has been captured by Ajax's forces and is developing gunpowder weapons for them under duress. Her rescue is the primary purpose of the Condemned's mission, although Ottavio de Caserta doesn't reveal that she's the asset the Condemned are looking for.

Playing Antiheroes

In most *Draw Steel* adventures, the players take on the role of brave heroes standing against villainy. While individual characters may have personal goals and motivations, the team is united by a desire to battle evil for the sake of doing so.

This adventure is a little different. In *The Condemned*, the characters have little in common except that they were unwillingly roped into the adventure. Some of the characters might be virtuous heroes unjustly imprisoned by a corrupt system, not too different from typical *Draw Steel* heroes. Others might be morally complex antiheroes out for themselves. And some might be unrepentant villains who'd burn the world down if they had a match.

Somehow, this ragtag group will have to work together to pull off a complex mission. Along the way, some characters may discover that being a hero isn't so bad—or, on the other hand, they may not.

Protagonists vs Heroes

This adventure isn't about saving the world because you're a hero. It's about saving the world *despite* the fact that you're *not* a hero. Therefore, throughout this adventure the main characters aren't referred to as "heroes" as they are in other *Draw Steel* adventures. They're referred to as "the protagonists" or "the Condemned." Only their actions will decide whether they're really heroes; they don't get that label for free.

Making Sure Everyone Has Fun

When people play villainous characters, it's important to establish ground rules. Find out what everyone is comfortable with.

While having this type of conversation, make sure everyone has the chance to veto any game element they're not comfortable with. The vetoed game element shouldn't be introduced by either the Director or the other players. Playing a roleplaying game is about everyone having fun together!

- Is everyone OK with characters committing on- or off-screen villainous actions, or having villainous actions in their backstory? Generally, many people find scenes of torture and cruelty unpleasant, and that doesn't change just because you're playing an antihero. Make sure everyone opts in before the Director or a player introduces such a scene.
- Does the party agree that they'd generally like to save the world, or will they try to subvert or escape the mission? In this case, you, as the Director, should think carefully about your vote. Even if the characters want to break some rules, the adventure will run more smoothly if the players limit themselves to "subvert the mission AND save the world" rather than "subvert the mission INSTEAD OF saving the world."
- How much player conflict does the group want? Should the players trust that their characters won't attack, rob from, or betray each other? Some groups might be OK with this kind of thing, and some may not. Find out up front before anyone gets a nasty surprise.

Dealing with Conflicts

Chances are that the players are used to playing heroic characters, with all the generosity and cooperativeness that implies. When a heroic party makes decisions, both the players and their characters typically follow the social contract, listening to each others' points of view and compromising appropriately.

Playing a villainous party can be a bit different. Teams of antiheroes often don't play nice together, and a little argument and jockeying for power is a classic part of the trope. However, if arguments arise, the players should make every effort to keep any arguments between the *characters*, not the *players*.

When two or more Condemned can't agree on a course of action, the players can use the following gamified way to settle the dispute. The players should always remember that it is their characters who are squabbling, not the players! The players are having fun roleplaying together, and if your character loses out now, that just means they're more likely to win later.

Power Grab

The Power Grab is a test that players can use to roleplay disputes between their characters. With Power Grabs, even the most antisocial characters can work together—at least temporarily.

When two or more characters disagree, one of the characters can initiate a Power Grab, which is a special opposed power roll. A Power Grab can represent a tense battle of wills, a polite debate, or even a kn0ck-down and drag-out fight. Any member of the group can participate in this test.

Any character who wishes to participate in the Power Grab states their case, bolstering their argument by making a test using their highest ability. If a character is arguing for an approach that would use a particular skill, they can use that skill on their power roll. For instance, if a character is advocating sneaking past guards, they can use the Hide or Sneak skill. Interpersonal skills like Brag, Intimidate, Lead, Lie, and Persuade can be used in nearly any Power Grab.

Once everyone who wishes to do so has made their test, the protagonist with the highest power roll wins the Power Grab. In the case of a tie, the tied protagonists repeat the test until there is a single winner.

The winner of the Power Grab gets to settle the current dispute, choosing the course of action. Each loser gains an edge on their next Power Grab: in a group of antiheroes, no one can stay in charge for long!

Creating an Antihero

This adventure is for level 3 characters. Players can either create a new character or use one of the provided pregenerated characters.

If a player is creating a new character, they should follow these steps:

1. Determine Backstory

Each character starts as an inmate in the Cauldron, Capital's prison.

Players should consider the following questions about their character:

What special precautions are in place to keep the character from escaping their cell? If a player isn't sure, you can offer some suggestions: an antimagic field? Guards with earplugs to protect

against magic or intense personal charm? Electrified or reinforced bars?

Prisoners are allowed to pursue a hobby or skill as long as they don't misbehave. **What is the character doing when the guards arrive?** Working out? Playing an instrument? Building a model? Or maybe you've never been cooperative enough to get a reward?

What is the character in for? Did they torch a tavern? Kill a hero? Pull off a heist?

How did they plead? Was the character set up? Did they take the fall to protect someone? Or are they as bad as everyone says, or even worse?

Note: The pregenerated characters in this adventure provide answers to some of these questions. As with any other aspect of these characters, these answers are just suggestions. Your players should feel free to rephrase, rewrite, or replace their characters' pregenerated backstories!

2. Choose a Complication

Villains tend to have outsized pasts. In a group of antiheroes, you can't throw a rock without hitting someone who made a deal with a fell entity, fell in a vat of acid, or otherwise had a brush with the sinister.

Although it's not required, each player can choose a complication (see Complications in *Draw Steel: Heroes*). They can also work with you to create a new complication, use one of the complications belonging to a pregenerated character, or use the complication below.

> **Sight of Blood**
>
> You like to dish out pain, not take it.
>
> While you are bleeding or winded, your abilities that cost a heroic resource cost one less of that heroic resource (minimum 1) if they deal damage, and they cost one more heroic resource if they don't deal damage.

3. Create a Title

Many villains and antiheroes are driven by their ambitions and passions. They are motivated by a desire so strong—for power, revenge, carnage, riches, or another goal—that they are willing to go to any end to fulfill it.

Each player can choose a 1st echelon title (see Titles in *Draw Steel: Heroes*), one that speaks to their past adventures or their motivating desires. A player can also work with you to create a new title, use a title belonging to one of the pregenerated characters, or use the title below.

> **Everything Looks Like a Nail**
>
> *"I've spent a lot of time honing this skill. Shame for all that effort to go to waste."*
>
> **Prerequisite:** Your compulsion to use a particular skill has gotten you into trouble.
>
> **Effect:** Choose a skill when you gain this title. The first time each game session that you make a test using this skill, you gain a Hero Token. Additionally, you gain an edge whenever you make a test using this skill.

4. Choose a Downtime Ability

As a level 3 character, each Condemned has already survived several escapades before the start of this adventure (including the one that landed them in jail). To represent this history, give the character a benefit from the Learn from a Master downtime ability (see Downtime Projects in *Draw Steel: Heroes*), gaining the Acquire Ability, Improve Ability, or Improve Control benefit.

Setup

It's recommended that you read each act of *The Condemned* in full before running it. The adventure has player choices that pay off later in the adventure, so make sure you have something handy to help you track these decisions.

For the First Session

For the first session, make sure you've read Chapter 1 beforehand. If you're playing in a digital format, you can also set up the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates map with its combatants beforehand.

LIST OF HANDOUTS IN THIS ADVENTURE

Handout: Creating a Condemned

Handout: Abbey of Saint Iphicrates

Handout: Experimental Gear

Handout: The Crysopolis

Handout: Armory Schematic

Handout Lady Letitia de Toera

Handout: Flying the *Justice on Wings of Iron*

Director Reference: Gerold's Head

Director Reference: Crysopolis Infiltration Montage Test

PART 1: SECURE THE ROUTE

You are the Condemned!

In this act, the protagonists—the Condemned—are freed from their maximum security prison in exchange for another, more dangerous form of servitude. They're given a mission: bring back a spy, dead or alive. If they succeed, they get to live another day. If they fail, they'll live another hour at most. After that, the loyalty collars locked around their necks will explode, killing them instantly.

After the initial briefing, the act starts when the heroes raid the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates to retrieve the spy.

Out of the Cauldron...

A memorable villain needs a badass introduction. Once the players have created or chosen their characters, read the following.

- "Each of you is a condemned criminal in the Cauldron, a maximum security prison in the city of Capital. The worst criminals are kept here, and you're considered the worst of the worst."
- "A troop of guards hauls you out of your cell. They cautiously snap a collar around your neck, shackle you, and lead you upstairs for the first time since your arrival."

Have each player introduce their character. If players are using this adventure's pregenerated characters, backstories are provided: players should feel free to use these backstories or invent their own.

As each character is introduced, give the player a chance to answer the following questions about their character.

What special precautions are in place to keep you from escaping your cell?

What are you doing when the guards arrive?

What are you in for?

How did you plead?

...Into the Fire

The Condemned are led to the most dangerous place in the Cauldron: the warden's office. But the warden isn't here. Instead, his desk is occupied by an unfamiliar noble.

This noble is Ottavio de Caserta, the spymaster for the House Vorona. He's the characters' new boss, although they don't know it yet, and it's his job to brief the Condemned on their new mission. De Caserta responds politely to short interruptions, but if he feels one of the Condemned is being disruptive, he causes their collar to deliver a painful shock, temporarily paralyzing and silencing them.

Have de Caserta give the following speech, which you can read or paraphrase.

- "Ah, good afternoon! Thank you for coming on such short notice. My name is Ottavio de Caserta, and I'm... well, let's just say I'm in charge and leave it at that."
- "I've studied your files. While you're all in the Cauldron for different crimes, you all share one thing in common. You're each condemned to death."
- "Personally, I think it's a waste to execute people with your talents, so I've made a deal with your warden for your service as special agents."
- "You may be curious about the collars around your neck. Unremovable, I'm afraid. If you disobey an order or fail the mission, the collar will explode--along with your head."
- "Guards, unshackle my Condemned. Does anyone have questions?"

Each of the Condemned is flanked by two guards, who remove the prisoner's shackles—except for the black metal loyalty collar around each of their necks.

As the prisoners are unshackled, ask each player in turn what, if anything, their character says or does next. You can read, paraphrase, or improvise de Caserta's response.

- **Asks about the collars:** "Repurposed enemy technology. The war dogs call them 'loyalty collars.' Care for a demonstration?" De Caserta points to a stone bust of a Caelian emperor in the corner of the room. A black collar around the bust's neck explodes, along with the bust, showering the room with stone shards. De Caserta brushes away stone dust from his shoulder. "I presume a demonstration on a live subject will not be necessary."
- **Asks about de Caserta:** "For now, you may call me Judge, Jury, Executioner: any or all of the above. I hold the power of life or death over each of you. I confess this is not a role I enjoy, but we all have our trials, as you know very well."
- **Asks about the mission:** "Let's call it... community service. Alas, I fear this community service is not much safer than a death sentence, but I think you will admit, after you've heard the briefing, that it is at least a chance."
- **Asks about their reward:** "I can offer freedom: your records expunged, your identity cleared, even erased if you like. You can put your old life behind you or go back to... whatever nefarious business landed you here in the first place, and I trust I won't see you here again."
- **Asks about another topic:** "Time is rather of the essence here: nonessential questions can wait."
- **Does nothing or agrees to help:** De Caserta nods approvingly and makes a note on a paper before him.
- **Insults de Caserta:** De Caserta makes a note on a paper before him and says, "Your opinion is noted."
- **Tries to attack or escape:** If one of the Condemned tries to attack, threaten de Caserta, or leave, they are racked with pain as their collar sends waves of paralyzing agony through their body. De Caserta says, "Ah! Thank you for the demonstration, well done! I don't think we'll need another, does anyone disagree?"

Sidebar: Refusing the Call
Villains don't like following orders, and at this point a character may want to tell de Caserta exactly what he can do with his loyalty collar. That's perfectly in keeping with antihero behavior. Furthermore, a senseless death at this point is a good way to establish this adventure's unique genre and stakes.

If you think one of your players would get a kick out of getting gruesomely killed, you can see if they want to work with you on a mind-blowing opening scene. You can privately check with the player beforehand, keeping the rest of the players in the dark, or discuss it at the table to make sure that everyone else is on board.

Let your player know that in addition to their starting character, they should have another character ready, such as one of the adventure's pregenerated characters. The player can even start the game with an expendable pregenerated character, keeping their real character in reserve!

The character doesn't believe de Caserta's threats. They defy him, daring him to use the loyalty collar.

There's a brief whine and then the character's head explodes, making quite a mess in the warden's nice clean office.

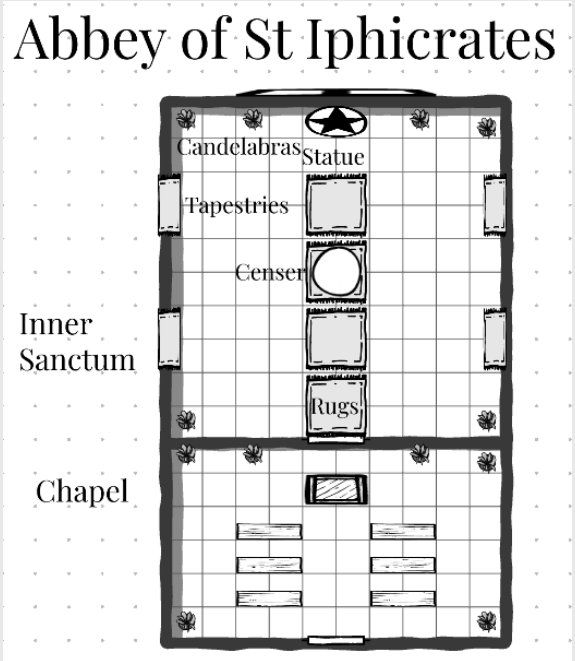
De Caserta tells a guard to bring in another prisoner—the player's second character. As a reward for the player for working with you on this scene, the party can start the game with a bonus Hero Token.

Plotting the Heist

- "De Caserta says, 'Now, before we survey the main course, I think an aperitif is in order. Think of it as a practice run.'"
- "'I don't expect you'll have too many problems. That said, success is necessary for the rest of the mission. Study this briefing document.'"

Share Handout:Abbey of Iphicrates with the players.

Handout: Abbey of St Iphicrates



Mission: Extract enemy spy, dead or alive (preferably alive). Minimize civilian casualties.

Target: "Gerold", real name unknown. A spy for Lord Ajax. Has been observed entering and leaving the Abbey of St Iphicrates.

Abbey of St Iphicrates: Location: Corner of Cartwright Street and Long Alley. Inhabitants: Abbot de Montese, Brother Aglio, Sister Aria. The **chapel** is open for public worship. The **inner sanctum** is for abbey inhabitants only.

Teleporter: The abbey contains a teleportation device that allows Gerold to leave the city. He must be apprehended before he can use the teleporter.

After the Condemned have read the document, De Caserta says,

- "'Unfortunately, we're in a bit of a rush. My spies received word that Gerold has just returned to the abbey with some rather interesting documents.'"
- "'He'll probably try to use the abbey's teleporter to return to his master, Lord Ajax. Stop him and bring us his documents.'"
- "'Any questions before you go?'"

If questioned, de Caserta has the following extra information:

- **Questioned About the Abbey:** "The safehouse is a local abbey dedicated to a minor Phaedran saint, Saint Iphicrates. Its abbot is suspected of Ajax sympathies, but it's not known whether he's a traitor or just a dupe of Gerold. While you're there, if time permits, make sure to see the tapestries. They're quite old and very beautiful."
- **Questioned About Ajax:** "We don't have time for a civics lesson, but let's say that Ajax believes he should rule Capital and Capital respectfully disagrees.
- **Questioned About Himself:** "'I'm just an overworked civil servant. And now, since you work for me, you are too.'"
- **Questioned About the Documents:** "I can't say much except that we'd very much like to have them."
- **Questioned About Gerold:** "He's a high-ranking agent in Ajax's operation. He will probably be in the inner sanctum, since the chapel is open to the public. He wears brightly-colored fireproof armor, but he usually covers it with a cloak or robe."
- **Questioned About Gerold's Goal:** "Our Gerry is a very naughty boy, but he's just part of a larger threat. Spies of Ajax have gained a foothold in the city, and they want to bring down the city from within. Up till now we haven't been able to capture one of Ajax's high-level spies. That ends today."
- **Questioned About the Team:** "I can't use my own people for this mission. I need skilled people unknown to Ajax's spy network. That's you."
- **Questioned About the Teleporter:** "We don't know where the teleporter is, but from watching Gerold's comings and goings we presume there is one. Once he activates it, it may take some time to warm up—but not too much time, so work fast."

When the players declare themselves ready, or when de Caserta gets impatient, de Caserta gives the following speech. Read or paraphrase the following:

- "De Caserta looks at his pocket watch. 'You'd better get going. It's a ten-minute walk to the abbey, and you are on the clock for this mission.'"
- "'You'll need to bring Gerold back in one hour, or your loyalty collars will detonate. Your time starts … now.' If the Condemned ask for more time, de Casertes says, 'If you don't catch him within an hour, he'll be long gone. You'd be surprised how much can be achieved in an hour, if you're properly motivated.'"

The Abbey of Saint Iphicrates

Sidebar: Time Limits

This mission has a time limit of one hour, but you don't need to track every minute. The Condemned have time to do everything they want to do, as long as they don't try to leave the neighborhood, spend a respite, or perform some other long-term activity. But you can certainly give the players the impression that every minute counts.

Sidebar: Saint Iphicrates

A Condemned who asks around (making a Presence test) or searches their memory (making a Reason test) can learn the following about Saint Iphicrates:

Learn about Saint Iphicrates Test:

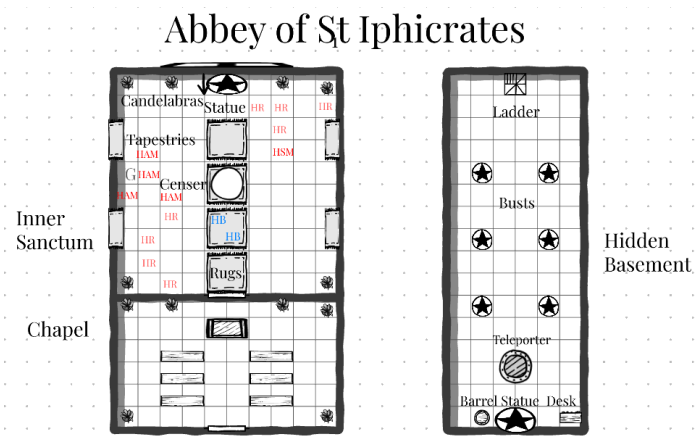
- **≤11:** Saint Iphicrates is a fairly obscure saint around here, but is far more popular in Phaedros (where Ajax is from).
- **12-16:** Saint Iphicrates saved the Caelian empire in its infancy, singlehandedly using javelins to pick off an army of invaders.
- **17+:** It's said that Saint Iphicrates was gifted with divine sight. Saint Iphicrates can supposedly see through the eyes of any statue or picture of him.

The Trip to the Abbey

It's dusk as the party leaves the prison and heads through the Stays to the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates. The neighborhood is busy during the day but unsafe at night: people are hurrying home to avoid its dangerous night life. Most of the people on the street, rightly assuming that the Condemned *are* the dangerous night life, try to avoid them. But if the characters stop passers-by and ask around about the Abbey, they can learn the following rumors:

- "Abbot de Montese is a fool, and he doesn't care about anyone without at least a knighthood. He's a strange choice for an abbot in a working neighborhood like ours."
- "There's a bunch of new monks around the abbey. If you live in the Stays long enough, you get an eye for dangerous people. These new guys may be monks, but they're also dangerous people."

Approaching the Abbey



Read or paraphrase the following:

- "The abbey is an unassuming stone building, looking much like any of the other workshops and warehouses in the neighborhood. It's identifiable as an abbey only by a painting of Saint Iphicrates's symbol (a hand holding a javelin) above the door."
- "The iron-spiked wooden door is ajar."
- (If the Condemned circle the building) "On the back wall is a huge stained-glass window. You can see that the interior of the abbey is brightly lit, but you can't see inside. The window doesn't open, but the top of it is broken: there's a hole where Saint Iphicrates' head would be."

If the Condemned enter through the door, they find themselves in the chapel (see Chapel). If they break through the stained-glass window, they enter the inner sanctum (see Inner Sanctum) and alert the inhabitants. If they climb up to the broken portion of the window, they may be able to enter the inner sanctum without alerting the inhabitants (see Stained-Glass Window).

Use the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates maps to run this encounter. Unless otherwise noted, the rooms in the abbey are 3 squares tall and lit by candelabras.

Chapel

- "In the chapel are three monks."

- "Two gaudily-dressed monks are sitting on benches, sipping from goblets. A third monk, wearing an ornate hat, is standing at an altar, pouring wine into his own goblet."
- "Behind the altar is a bronze door."

The monks in the chapel are the abbot and his two monks. They have no knowledge of the Ajax spy ring in their midst, although they are mildly pro-Ajax.

The Condemned can try to get by the monks by walking past them, attacking them, or talking with them.

Walking Past the Monks

The chapel is open to the public, and the Condemned are welcome. The bronze door, however, is off limits. If the Condemned head for the door, the monks warn them away. If the Condemned ignore the warnings, the monks give the alarm, alerting the inhabitants of the Inner Sanctum.

Attacking the Monks

The monks are **noncombantants**. Unless all the monks are killed on the first turn of combat, any remaining monks yell for help, alerting the inhabitants of the Inner Sanctum.

Talking with the Monks

The hat-wearing monk at the altar is Abbot de Montese, a vain and overbearing Riojan of noble birth. The other monks don't add much to the conversation: they do nothing but agree with de Montese, who answers any questions addressed to them. If questioned, Abbot de Montese has the following information:

- **Questioned About the Neighborhood:** "This neighborhood is full of low-born people—not quite the element I'm used to, as you can guess. I don't know why we were assigned here; we should be in a better neighborhood among our own sort. This city is badly mismanaged and badly needs a change in government."
- **Questioned About Ajax:** "Oh, Lord Ajax? He's... uh... what's your opinion?" (de Montese agrees with any opinion the Condemned express; while he's mildly pro-Ajax, he's not interested in arguing about it.)
- **Questioned About Gerold:** "That Gerold fellow is some sort of special inquisitor. He showed me an order from the Lord Abbot granting him exclusive access to the inner sanctum. I'm not even allowed into the wine cellar! But one must follow the dictates of the Lord Abbot, however mysterious."
- **Questioned About St Iphicrates:** "A true hero. Built a mighty empire, conquering the land that would once become Capital. Some day Lord Ajax may follow his example—not that I'm pro Ajax, of course."
- **Questioned About the Wine:** "This is Riojan Gold, the '37 vintage. No, you can't have any. It's my personal stock, and I can't get more if I'm not allowed in the inner sanctum."
- **Questioned About the Wine Cellar:** "It's beneath the... uh... it's for abbey folks only."

One of the Condemned can try to convince the Abbot to let them into the sanctum with a hard Presence test. The test has an edge if the heroes play on the Abbot's vanity, claim to be noble born, or claim to be sent by the Church of Saint Iphicrates.

Win Over the Abbot Presence Test:

- **≤11:** The Abbot becomes suspicious. He yells, alerting the inhabitants of the inner sanctum, and then demands the Condemned leave the abbey.
- **12-16:** The Abbot becomes suspicious of the character who made the test, and that character can no longer make a Win Over the Abbot Presence test (although other characters may do so).
- **17+:** The abbot allows the heroes to enter the inner sanctum without alerting its occupants.

Combat: Inner Sanctum

- "Robed figures sit or stand around the room. They're dressed like monks but they hold themselves like soldiers."
- "The air is heavy with an overpowering smell of incense and oil."
- "A huge flaming bowl—an incense censer—dangles a few feet above the floor, suspended from the rafters by a chain."
- "In front of the stained-glass window is a huge statue, twice life size, of a blindfolded Saint Iphicrates holding a javelin."
- When he sees you, a monk leaning against the wall waves a wine bottle and sneers, "Oh look, the brave heroes have arrived to save the city!"

Secret: The monk with the wine bottle is Gerold. He's indistinguishable from the other monks until he takes fire damage, burning away his cloak and exposing his red Adaptive Second Skin of Flame beneath.

Secret: The carpet and tapestries are permeated with lamp oil. If exposed to fire, they instantly burst into flames (see Carpet and Tapestries below).

Secret: Under the statue of Saint Iphicrates is a passageway that leads to the Hidden Basement.

Sidebar: Villainous One-Liners

Like most villains, Gerold (the monk with the wine bottle) likes to hear himself talk. He keeps up a stream of chatter through the battle, mocking the Condemned when he's feeling confident and threatening them when things go badly. But this time, Gerold's not the only villainous chatterbox in town. In this and in future scenes, reward the Condemned with a Hero Point whenever one of them delivers a particularly clever comeback or one-liner.

Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

Inner Sanctum Groups

Group	Creatures
1	**Gerold** (captain) **Four human apprentice mages** (minion squad)
2	**Human storm mage** (captain) **Four human raiders** (minion squad)
3	**Two human brawlers**
4	**Four human raiders**

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add **two human brawlers** to group 3 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove the **human storm mage** at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove **group 2 and group 4** at the start of the encounter.

Candelabras

The room contains six lit candelabras. A creature can use an action to push or throw a candelabra up to 3 squares. If the candelabra enters a patch of flammable oil, that patch is set on fire.

Carpet and Tapestries

The carpet and tapestries are permeated with lamp oil, turning the inner sanctum into a potential fire trap.

The carpet acts as four contiguous 2-square x 2-square patches of **flammable oil**.

Each of the four tapestries in the room acts as 2-square x 2-square patches of flammable oil on the wall, affecting any creature that is force moved into that section of the wall.

A patch of flammable oil catches on fire if a flaming object or creature enters its space or is thrown or pushed into it. Additionally, at the end of each round, any patch of flammable oil catches on fire if it is adjacent to another burning patch of flammable oil (meaning that fire can spread across the carpet in a few rounds).

Once the tapestries have been set on fire, the whole abbey is endangered. Unless all fires are extinguished within 1 minute, the fire spreads to all floors and rafters in the abbey, which now act like ignited flammable oil and can't be extinguished. After 10 minutes, the entire abbey collapses in flames, killing anyone remaining in the chapel and inner sanctum and covering the entrance to the hidden basement with rubble.

Incense Censer

The **incense censer** is filled with incense and hot coals, filling the room with strong-smelling smoke. The incense censer doesn't set nearby oil patches alight unless someone uses its Boiling Oil ability and includes an oil patch in the area.

The censer is suspended above the floor. Creatures that are prone and creatures that are 1S or smaller can move through its space.

Rafters

The top of the inner sanctum is criss-crossed with wooden beams 1 square below the ceiling. A creature balancing on these beams can move to any square in the inner sanctum and has cover from creatures below them.

Stained-Glass Window

The stained-glass window (a scene of an army lying dead before Saint Iphicrates) can't be seen through or opened, but it allows illumination to pass through into and out of the inner sanctum. The glass has 1 Stamina. While it is unbroken, a creature passing through it takes 5 damage.

There's a missing piece of glass at the top of the window (where Saint Iphicrates' head would be). A creature that climbs the outside wall can make a hard Agility test to squeeze though the hole.

Climb Through the Window Agility Test:

- **≤11:** The creature fails to get through the window and alerts the enemies in the Inner Sanctum.
- **12-16:** The creature passes through the window, reaching the Rafters. The creature takes 4 damage from the window's broken glass.
- **17+:** The creature passes through the window, reaching the Rafters.

Statue of Saint Iphicrates

The room is dominated by a huge statue of Saint Iphicrates holding a javelin. The statue is wearing a cloth blindfold. The statue's base is on hidden rollers and the statue can be easily moved. It has a Stability of 0, and creatures that enter its space push it without taking damage themselves. Underneath the statue's base is a laddered shaft leading down to the Hidden Basement.

Tactics

When the battle begins, the Condemned start near the door (if they came through the sanctuary) or the window (if they came through the window). If near the door, several Condemned are likely to be standing on areas of flammable carpet.

If the enemies were alerted, the enemies go first in the round. If the enemies were not alerted, they are surprised and the Condemned go first.

The first time Gerold acts, he tries to burn as many heroes as possible using his I'm Getting Fired Up malice action to set a carpet alight and then pushes the statue aside to escape into the Hidden Basement. His human apprentice mages go with him, leaving his other allies to cover his retreat. Gerald doesn't attempt to avoid himself or allies with his fire abilities, trusting his fire immunity to protect him.

No more than once per turn, the human raiders use the incense censer's Boiling Oil or Swing Censor actions. They charge as often as possible. The human brawlers and the human storm mage push opponents into flaming areas.

If the Condemned enter the Hidden Basement, the enemies follow them.

Stat Blocks

GEROLD MALICE — **MALICE FEATURES**

At the start of the turn of Gerold or one of his allies, you can spend malice to activate one of the following features.

I'm Getting Fired Up! (Free Maneuver) ◆ 3 Malice

Gerold or one of his allies throws a candle onto a patch of flammable oil, or uses a maneuver or main action belonging to an **incense censer** or patch of **flammable oil**.

Fiery Embrace (Action) ◆ 5 Malice

Keywords Melee, Strike

Distance Melee 1 — **Target** All enemies

✦ ≤11 7 fire damage

★ 12–16 10 fire damage; R<2 grabbed; burning (save ends)

✸ 17 14 fire damage; R<3 grabbed; burning (save ends)

Effect The creature taking the action becomes burning. A burning creature or object takes 1D6 fire damage at the start of each of their turns until the effect ends.

Lord Ajax, Aid Me Now! (Maneuver) ◆ 7 Malice

Keywords Magic

Distance Self — **Target** Self

Effect If Gerold is in the Hidden Basement, the Ajax-headed statue of Saint Iphicrates activates. It acts as an **arrow launcher**. It is mechanized and it takes its own turn during combat, on which it can use one of its own main action without needing an adjacent creature to provide the action. It can only use Reload while the bucket of javelins is adjacent to it.

Human brawler

Human storm mage

Human apprentice mage

Human raider

Oil patch

Incense censer is a size 2 boiling oil cauldron with the following additional action:

Swing Censer (Adjacent Creature Main Action)

-

Melee 1 — This object

Effect: The triggering creature pushes the censer up to 3 squares, and can choose to shift 1 square as part of this push. After this movement, the censer returns to its starting position and then moves the same number of squares in the exact opposite direction from the first movement. It then returns to its original position again. During the censer's movement, any creature in the censer's space that is 1M or larger or not prone is hit by the censer, taking 10 damage. A creature who has Might < 2 is prone.

GEROLD — **LEVEL 3 LEADER**
HUMAN, HUMANOID — EV 20

1M	5	120	0	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 4, fire 3, psychic 4 **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight +1 A gility +3 R eason +2 I ntuition +3
P resence +2

r **Broken Bottle** 2d10 + 3 **Signature Ability**
Melee, Ranged, Strike, Weapon Main Action
e Melee 1 or ranged 5 x Two creatures or objects
≤11 8 damage
12–16 12 damage; M < 2 bleeding
17+ 15 damage; M < 3 bleeding
2 Malice: This ability targets one additional target.

r **Kick Away** 2d10 + 3
Melee Maneuver
e Melee 1 x One enemy
≤11 Push 1; M < 1 prone
12–16 Push 2; M < 2 prone
17+ Push 3; M < 3 prone
Effect: Gerold shifts one square.

! **Swig of Wine**
Magic Triggered Action
e Self
Trigger: Gerold makes a power roll.
Effect: Gerold takes 5 damage which can't be reduced in any way and increases the outcome of the power roll by one tier.

t **End Effect:** At the end of each of his turns, Gerold can take 5 damage to end one effect on him that can be ended by a saving throw. This damage can't be reduced in any way.
t **Supernatural Insight**
Gerold ignores concealment if it's granted by a supernatural effect.

d **Throw Bottle** **Villain Action 1**
Area
e 2 cube within 5 x Special
Effect: The area becomes a patch of Flammable Oil and immediately catches fire as if it been activated. If the Incense Censer is in the area, this counts as using the incense Censer's Reload action.

r **Warm Up the Teleporter!** **Villain Action 2**
Melee
e Melee 1 x Special
Effect: Gerold yells a command word. The teleporter in the basement hums to life and begins glowing. Its glow increases in brightness each turn. It will become operational in 5 turns from the time it activates.

r **Burn Before Reading** **Villain Action 3**
Area
e 3 cube within 5 x Special
Effect: While adjacent to the desk, Gerold sets alight one document from the desk and then crams the burning document into his mouth. Gerold then breathes fire, making the power roll below and targeting each creature in the area. Gerold can repeat this villain action three times, each time destroying one document.
≤11 9 fire damage
12–16 14 fire damage
17+ 18 fire damage

Hidden Basement

- "A ladder leads down to a rough-carved basement with a vaulting ceiling."
- "Six busts of Caelian emperors stand on pillars, flanking a path that leads to a big statue at the far end of the basement."
- "The statue was probably once Saint Iphicrates—it's holding javelins—but its head has been replaced by a newer, more classically handsome head that looks like Ajax."
- "In front of the statue is a round platform of black stone."
- "Near the statue are barrels of javelins and racks of wine bottles."
- "Against the wall is a desk covered with papers."

Busts of Emperors

The six busts of Caelian emperors are magical explosives. Each explodes when a creature or object (including ammunition) comes within 1 square of it, dealing 10 damage to each creature and object in the area. Weapon ammunition is destroyed by this explosion, which gives Gerold a powerful defense against mundane ranged attacks should he be able to reach the far end of the Hidden Basement.

Gerald and the apprentice mages' movements don't trigger the heads' explosions.

The Condemned can bypass the busts by setting off enough of them to make a path (at least three), by using magical ranged or area effects that don't use ammunition, or by using teleportation or other magical means.

Defaced Statue

The statue, once sacred to Saint Iphicrates, has had its head replaced by a bust of Ajax. The statue is a mechanism that Gerold can activate, letting it act like a self-firing **arrow launcher.**

Desk

On Gerold's desk are three documents that Ottavio de Caserta would like the heroes to rescue. They're written in code, but de Caserta's people can decode them.

Supplies

Next to the statue are supplies: a barrel of javelins (within reach of the statue) and racks of wine bottles. There are 21 wine bottles, of which 18 are ordinary and 3 are the '37 Riojan gold (a rare vintage).

Teleporter

Once Gerold has used his Warm Up the Teleporter villain action, the teleporter takes five turns to become active. Once it is active, Gerold can use a main action to teleport out of the city. Only Gerold can use the teleporter, since only he knows its password.

The teleporter has 20 Stamina. If it is reduced to 0 Stamina, it can't be used until someone spends a minute repairing it.

Tactics

If Gerold survives the battle in the Inner Sanctum, he moves straight to his desk. At the first opportunity, he uses his Lord Ajax, Aid Me Now Malice ability to rain javelins on enemies and then uses Warm Up the Teleporter. When he is next to his desk, he uses his Burn Before Reading villain action on each of his turns, destroying a document from his desk each time he does so. The desk contains 3 documents. If Gerold manages to destroy all three documents, he taunts the players: "You're too late! My secrets will escape with me!" and then heads for the teleporter.

Gerold and his apprentice mages can freely pass near the explosive emperors' heads without setting them off, as can their magical attacks and the attacks of the statue of Saint Iphicrates. Gerold's minions fight until Gerold is killed or captured; Gerold surrenders if the situation looks hopeless.

Winning the Encounter

The encounter ends successfully when the heroes escape the abbey with Gerold (dead or alive). Any surviving monks don't follow.

Loot

Gerold wears an Adaptive Second Skin of Flames, which he uses in battle.

Adaptive Suit of Flames (like Adaptive Second Skin of Toxins but it protects against fire instead)

Returning to de Caserta

After the Condemned successfully recover Gerold (or his body), they can return to de Caserta's office in the Cauldron (possibly leaving the abbey in flames behind them.)

- If the Condemned return with a living Gerold and at least one document, de Caserta is pleased: "Excellent! You've performed up to my high expectations. As always, the reward for success is… a more difficult challenge in the future. But we can discuss that later." The heroes gain 2 Victories each.
- If the Condemned return with Gerald's corpse or didn't save any documents, de Caserta is disappointed: "You did well enough to save your skins, but it seems you're a blunt instrument rather than a scalpel. Don't worry, you'll have a chance to redeem yourselves in the future." The heroes gain 1 Victory each.

Wanted Dead or Alive

If the Condemned brought back Gerold dead, de Caserta shakes his head. "Gerold's condition is unfortunate, but we have ways to make sure his secrets don't die with him." Scientists drag Gerold's body away.

If the Condemned brought back Gerold alive, he is defiant. He snarls, "I'll die before I reveal any secrets!" De Caserta replies, "Die first… reveal your secrets first… let's not quibble about the order." Guards drag a struggling Gerold away.

Gearing Up

After Gerold's retrieval, de Caserta tells the Condemned that their next briefing will begin shortly—but first, they can each requisition one piece of experimental gear.

Guards lead the heroes to a room filled with weaponry and armor. The walls and floor are covered with burn marks and rubble, and several nervous scientists stand by to explain and demonstrate the gear. The scientists handle the gear gingerly, performing demonstrations with protective gear that is not offered to the Condemned.

Each Condemned can take three Blackpowder Grenades (of any variety) and one of the following pieces of gear. The gear available is summarized on Handout: Experimental Gear.

Resting Up

De Caserta tells the team that since they've successfully extracted the spy, their final mission will start tomorrow. The Condemned can take a Respite. "Unfortunately, we don't have any luxurious accommodations. You'll have to spend one more night in your cells."

Getting Ahead

Once the team is assembled the next morning, de Caserta has one final piece of gear for them. Scientists bring in Gerold's head, preserved inside a liquid-filled clear dome. Gerold's head appears to be alive.

De Caserta gives Gerold's head to one of the Condemned. "We came to a post-mortem agreement with Gerold. He'll act as a tour guide on your next mission." De Caserta pats the top of the glass dome. "Very well behaved now, is our Gerold."

De Caserta explains the buttons that operate the glass dome. One button mutes Gerold's speaker for one minute if he's being particularly annoying, and a second button gives him a shock if he's being uncooperative. A valve allows you to refresh his water (it should be changed daily).

If the party saved any of Gerold's documents, De Caserta also gives the heroes a paper on which are written passcodes: three passcodes, minus one passcode for each document that Gerold ate. "I'm sure you'll find a use for these later."

Gerold's Head

Gerold's head is alive, and has his original personality: spiteful, treacherous, greedy, and boastful.

Gerold doesn't want to fall into Ajax's hands—Ajax isn't particularly merciful to those who fail—but he also hates de Casertes' minions for reducing him to a mere head. He obeys the party's commands and answers their questions truthfully, all while keeping up a steady stream of sarcasm and insults. If the Condemned frequently insult him, he's quite willing to complicate their lives by providing incomplete information or by talking loudly at inconvenient times.

Gerold is susceptible to threats and bribes. He doesn't like being shocked, but he hates being silenced even more. He is also a wine connoisseur, especially fond of Riojan Gold (the expensive wine kept in the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates). He frequently asks for Riojan Gold or any other decent vintage. If a bottle of fine wine is poured into his valve, he briefly becomes friendly and cooperative, and may even volunteer useful information without being asked.

Interrogating Gerold

Gerold answers questions truthfully, but he never volunteers information without being asked first (until it's no longer useful). When asked specific questions, he provides the following information about the Crysopolis.

- **Questioned about ADVANCE or the asset:** "Lord Ajax has big plans for using the asset to ADVANCE his ambitions. He's codenamed it ADVANCE. Get it? He's a riot. The asset is probably somewhere in the Redoubt. I don't know where or what it is."
- **Questioned about Ajax: "**He's probably going to conquer the world, and when he does he won't be super merciful to me. He doesn't like losers. So let's stay out of his way."
- **Questioned about the Armory:** "Ajax builds war dogs there. Sure, ADVANCE could possibly be there."
- **Asked for general help:** Gerold provides some unhelpful response. Examples: "My memory is pretty short." "All this talking makes my throat sore. Could use a drink." "The plan seems pretty simple. Find the asset. Steal the asset. Steal a ship. Get caught by Ajax. End up sewed together into a single war dog."
- **Questioned about the Back Alleys, healing, or rest:** "Sleep is for the weak. I usually just get injectables in the back alleys. They really keep you going."
- **Questioned about an escape route:** "You can't teleport off the island without passwords I don't have. Might be able to steal an airship in the Redoubt."
- **Questioned about the Gambling District:** "Fun place. Fun place. Not sure how it fits in the mission but we should definitely go there."
- **Questioned about High Street, Riojan Gold, or wine:** "High Street in the Crysopolis is a great place to pick up good wine. We should head over there immediately."
- **Questioned about Khavettra (after meeting him):** "I don't know him and I don't like his stupid face."
- **Questioned about Lady Letitia (after rescuing her):** "Huh, the asset is a person, who knew?"
- **Questioned about Low Street or the Back Streets:** "That place is for manual laborers, dwarves, and other losers with no reason for living. You'll fit right in."
- **Questioned about loyalty collars or the Lower Docks:** "If you're looking to get those loyalty collars off, might find somone who knows someone in the lower docks."
- **Questioned about the Palace:** "Lord Ajax lives there. Sure, ADVANCE could possibly be there. But we should… probably not go there."
- **Asked specifically for passwords or passcodes:** "Thought you'd never ask. I know a bunch of Crysopolis passwords. " The Condemned gain 2 intel the first time they ask Gerold for this information.
- **Questioned about Record Control:** "It's the center of Ajax's spy operation. I used to go there to report to my handler. I probably can't go in there without my body though. Sure, ADVANCE could possibly be there, I guess."

- **Questioned about the Redoubt (before entering it):** "It's Ajax's fortress. Can't get in or out without the right passwords. I have some old passwords. I'm pretty sure they'll work. Pretty sure."
- **Questioned about the sewers or the Underwalks:** "The sewers do travel all over the Crysopolis, leading down to the Underwalks. We could use them to get into the Redoubt, except they're filled with murderous dwarves."
- **Questioned about the Sky Harbor:** "That's where airships dock. We should head there when we're ready to escape."
- **Questioned about UNISOL:** "I heard Ajax was making an alliance with sinister creatures from another dimension, Seems like a great idea, what could go wrong?"
- **Questioned about the teleporter (before going to the Crysopolis):** "Oh, I didn't mention this to de Caserta but it's a one-way teleporter. Can't wait to not see his face when he realizes. We'll need to find another escape route when we're done with the mission." If informed of this, De Caserta is furious but still goes ahead with the mission.

Handout: Experimental Gear

Ashen Armor

Made of spiked bone plates, this armor steals the souls of your victims.

Keywords: Heavy Armor, Magic

1st Level: While you wear this armor, you gain a +6 bonus to Stamina. When you reduce a creature to 0 Stamina with a strike, you gain a surge.

5th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +12. When you reduce a creature to 0 Stamina with a strike, you can spend a Recovery.

9th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +21. When you reduce a creature to 0 Stamina with a strike, you gain temporary Stamina equal to the creature's maximum Stamina or your Recovery Value, whichever is less.

Blackpowder Grenade

These grenades made from an advanced explosive are highly restricted; this is the first time you've ever (legally) owned one.

Keywords: Hands, Magic

Effect: As a main action, you can throw the grenade. Use the following ability.

> Blackpowder Grenade
>
> *Count to three, then throw..*
>
> Area, Magic Main action
>
> e 3 cube within 5 Each creature and object in the area
>
> Power Roll + Might, Agility, or Reason
>
> á 5 + M, A, or R damage
>
> é 8 + M, A, or R damage
>
> í 11 + M, A, or R damage

Besides the standard model, several specialized varieties of blackpowder grenade are available:

Ignition Grenade: This grenade is inaudible and deals fire damage.

Stun Grenade: This grenade deals sonic damage. A creature that would be killed by the grenade's damage is instead knocked unconscious for 1 hour.

Remote Grenade: The grenade doesn't explode until 1 minute has passed or you use a maneuver to detonate it remotely.

Shaped Grenade: The grenade deals 15 damage but only to creatures and objects in its square.

Blackpowder Launcher

This bulky arm-mounted tube fires powerful blackpowder rockets.

Keywords: Hands, Magic

Effect: You can use the ability below. Once you have done so, you can't do so again until you use a main action to reload the blackpowder launcher. Using the blackpowder launcher doesn't expend a Blackpowder Grenade.

> Blackpowder Rocket
>
> *A thunk, a brief whistling sound, and then utter destruction.*
>
> Area, Magic Main action
>
> e 3 cube within 10 Each creature and object in the area
>
> Power Roll + Might, Agility, or Reason
>
> á 5 + M, A, or R damage; slide 1
>
> é 8 + M, A, or R damage; slide 1
>
> í 11 + M, A, or R damage; slide 1

Incineration Lance

Liquid fire jets from nozzles along this spear's haft.

Keywords: Magic, Polearm

1st Level: Any weapon ability that deals rolled damage using this weapon deals an extra 1 fire damage. Additionally, you gain the following action.

> Flame Thrower
>
> *Flame gouts from the lance, cooking everyone nearby.*
>
> Area, Magic Main action
>
> e 2 cube within 1 Each creature and object in the area
>
> Power Roll + Agility or Might
>
> á 4 + M or A damage
>
> é 6 + M or A damage
>
> í 9 + M or A damage
>
> **Effect:** If you used this ability since the start of your last turn, the lance overheats and your space is included in the area.

5th Level: The weapon's extra fire damage increases to 2, and this extra fire damage is applied to the weapon's Flame Thrower ability.

9th Level: The weapon's extra fire damage increases to 3, and this extra fire damage is applied to the weapon's Flame Thrower ability.

Infiltration Suit

This slick leather armor covers you completely except for your face.

Keywords: Light Armor, Magic

1st Level: While you wear this armor, you gain a +6 bonus to Stamina, and you can use a maneuver to give your face the illusory appearance of any bipedal creature of equivalent size that you have previously seen. Your body, clothing, and gear are unchanged.

5th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +12. Additionally, when you use this armor to transform your face, your voice is transformed as well.

9th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +21. Additionally, you can use a main action to become invisible until the start of your next turn.

Power Glove

When you strain your psi-augmented muscles, this metal-veined glove hums with the sound of your sizzling neurons.

Keywords: Hands, Psychic

Effect: While you wear this glove, your Might score is equal to the highest of your Reason, Intuition, or Presence scores if it is lower than that score.

The Silencer

This articulated metal whip coils and uncoils at your mind's command.

Keywords: Psionic, Whip

1st Level: Any weapon ability that deals rolled damage using this weapon deals an extra 1 psychic damage. Additionally, you gain a +1 bonus to the distance of the Grab maneuver and a grabbed creature can't speak.

5th Level: The weapon's extra psychic damage increases to 2, and a creature grabbed by you can't breathe.

9th Level: The weapon's extra psychic damage increases to 3, and you gain a +1 bonus to the distance of your melee weapon abilities made with the whip.

Targeting Lens

This red lens covers a single eye. Its crimson glow can be seen only by the creatures you have marked for death.

Keywords: Head, Psychic

Effect: While you wear this lens, you can use a maneuver to target a creature you can see. Until you target a different creature, you always know the creature's distance and direction, you and the creature can't be concealed from each other, and while the creature is winded you know their remaining Stamina total. When you deal damage to the creature with an ability, the creature takes extra damage equal to your highest characteristic.

PART 2: INFILTRATE THE CRYSOPOLIS

Reach for the Skies

In this act, the Condemned teleport to the Crysopolis, the flying capital city of Lord Ajax. There they must infiltrate the city looking for an unidentified "asset" that has been stolen by Ajax's forces. They're to return the asset to the Cauldron in Capital within 48 hours.

After the initial briefing, the action starts when the heroes teleport to the Crysopolis.

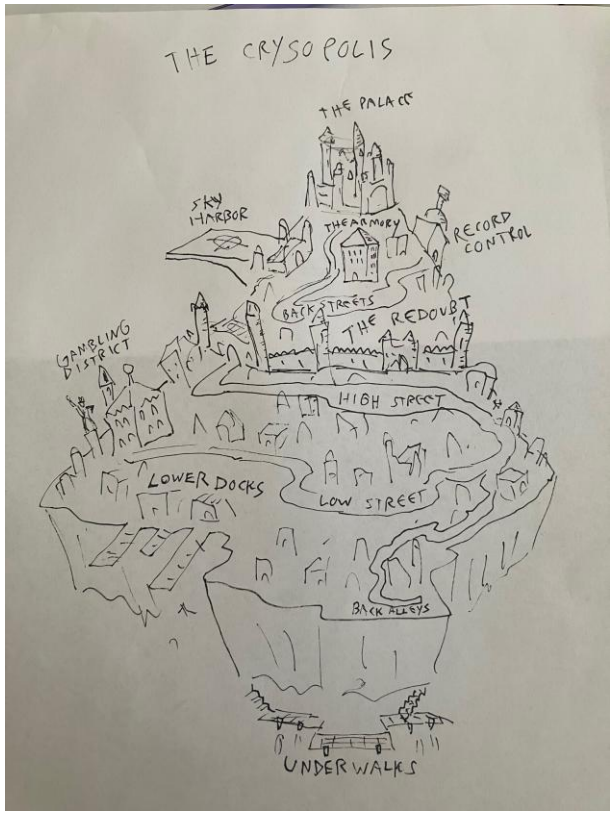
Charting the Crysopolis

The next morning, guards bring the team back to de Caserta's office. De Caserta gives them a map of the Crysopolis (Handout: The Crysopolis).

This handout includes lines to track the team's intel and the city's alarm level. If the players ask about these lines, let them know that you will explain these later.

Handout: The Crysopolis

[Handout has 3 elements: Chrysopolis map; intel tracker; alarm level tracker.



Mission Briefing

De Caserta gives the following briefing, which you can read or paraphrase.

- "This is the moment you've been waiting for: your chance for freedom. If you are successful, your loyalty collars will be removed and you'll receive full pardons."
- "In the basement of the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates is a teleportation pad. It requires Gerold here to speak a command word."
- "Your destination is the Crysopolis: Ajax's capital city."
- "Ajax has stolen a military asset of enormous value, codenamed ADVANCE. You'll be extracting the asset."
- "Oh, and one more thing. Your time limit for this mission is 48 hours. Have the asset here by then, or I will be forced to presume the mission is a failure and detonate your loyalty collars. Good hunting!"

If questioned, de Caserta has the following extra information:

- **Questioned About the Asset:** "The less you know about ADVANCE, the better. Just know this: if Ajax can unlock its secrets, he may find himself king of all the world somewhat faster than we could muster a defense. We don't know its precise location but Gerold has graciously agreed to be your guide to Crysopolis."
- **Questioned About the Crysopolis:** "You've undoubtedly heard a lot about the Crysopolis: the body banks, the war dogs. But it's a city like any other. People live there. Do business. Get up to no good. You should be able to find plenty of cracks in Ajax's armor.."
- **Questioned About Gerold:** "You can trust him... up to a point. He certainly doesn't want to fall back into Ajax's hands, after failing the way he did."
- **Questioned About the Plan:** "You'll teleport into the Crysopolis now, and back out when you have the asset. I don't know what you'll find when you get there; you'll have to improvise."
- **Questioned About the Time Limit:** "48 hours is not an arbitrary value. We estimate this is how long it will take Ajax to unlock the technology he stole from us."

De Caserta answers only a few questions before he hurries the team away, assuring them that Gerold can provide further information once they get to the Crysopolis.

Return to the Abbey

The teleporter is in the basement of the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates. Because of the "disturbance" last night, the abbey (or its smoldering ruin) is under occupation by the City Watch.

Although the City Watch is keeping civilians away from the scene, their officer, Sergeant Dalla, is expecting the Condemned: de Caserta told her he'd be sending a team of "top experts." She escorts them to the basement.

If the three bottles of Riojan '37 wine are still in the basement, Gerold begs the team to take a few bottles along: "That's a good vintage and you can't get it just anywhere." He has no interest in the basement's other, inferior wines.

Once the entire team is assembled on the teleporter, Gerold speaks a command word (Ajax Undying!), and the team is teleported to the Crysopolis.

Combat: Entering the Crysopolis

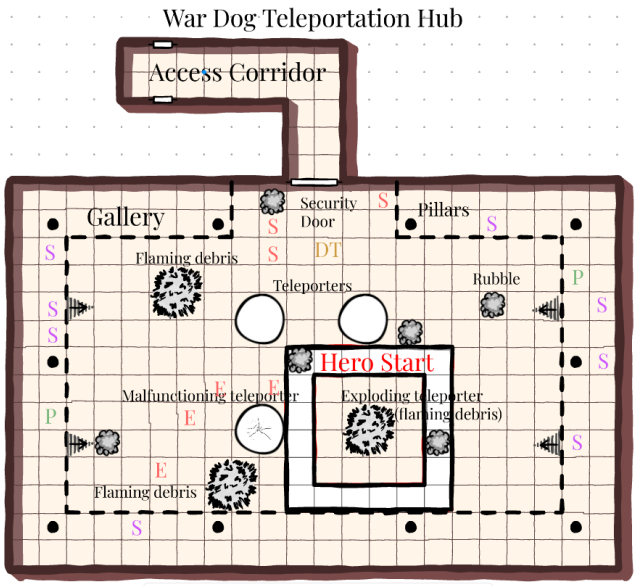
- "You appear on a teleportation pad in a wide, galleried chamber that contains several other pads."
- "The room is filled with soldiers wearing loyalty collars—war dogs. Some are patrolling the galleries, others are repairing a teleportation pad, and others are guarding a big metal door."
- "Gerold's head turns to you and says, 'Oh, one thing I forgot to mention to de Caserta. This is a one-use teleporter.'"
- "The teleporter pad whines and then explodes."

The Condemned have enough time to leap off the teleporter pad before it explodes, landing in any space 2 squares away from it. A character that stays within 1 square of the platform is affected by the burning machinery (see Flaming Debris). Flaming debris and rubble rains across the room, temporarily sealing the exit and preventing the war dogs from immediately sending for help.

Use the War Dog Teleportation Hub map to run this encounter. The area is four squares tall and is lit by glowing metal wall panels.

Bluffing By

The guards have been told to watch for Gerold's return by teleporter. If one of the Condemned is disguised as Gerold, the party can pass through this room without a fight, gaining 1 Victory each. Showing Gerold's head won't allow passage.



Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

War Dog Teleportation Hub Groups

Group	Creatures
1	**War dog doomthief** (captain) **Four war dog sweepers** (minion squad)
2	**Two war dog eviscerites**
3	**Two war dog eviscerites**
4	**War dog phosphorite** (captain) **Four war dog sharpshooters** (minion squad)
5	**War dog phosphorite** (captain) **Four war dog sharpshooters** (minion squad)
6	**Three lava** (flaming debris)

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add one **one war dog eviscerite** to Group 2 and Group 3 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove **group 3** at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove **group 3 and group 5** at the start of the encounter.

Access Corridor

The access corridor is a hallway outside the war dog teleportation hub. Two doors lead to other parts of the compound. A creature who passes through one of these two doors has left the encounter.

Security Door

The security door is two squares wide and two squares tall. Each square of the door has 12 Stamina. The door's controls have been destroyed by debris from the explosion. The only way to get through the door is by destroying one of its squares.

Flaming Debris

The explosion sends flaming debris around the room. The teleporter's original location, and two other areas in the room, are filled with **flaming debris**.

Gallery

A gallery platform, 2 squares off the floor, runs around the room.

The gallery is supported by pillars from the ceiling. A pillar provides cover. A pillar has 5 Stamina; if it is destroyed, the gallery within 3 squares of the pillar collapses to the floor. A creature on or under the gallery when it collapses takes 10 damage and falls prone.
Four staircases lead up to the gallery.

Rubble

The explosion has littered rubble around the room. The rubble is difficult terrain and provides cover.

Teleporter Pads

The room originally housed four 2x2-square teleporter pads (now three). The other three pads use codes unknown to anyone present and can't be used by the Condemned. Additionally, one of the other teleporter pads is malfunctioning and is undergoing maintenance (enthusiastically conducted by the four war dog eviscerites using their chainsaw whips). A creature that enters the malfunctioning teleporter pad's space or starts their turn there takes 5 lightning damage.

Each teleporter has 10 Stamina. If destroyed, a teleporter explodes, filling its space with **flaming debris.**

Tactics

The war dog doomthief (the commanding officer) and the war dog sweepers start the encounter near the door. Once the door controls are wrecked by the explosion, the doomthief attacks a section of a door. Once it's broken, she moves into the access corridor, using her shrikegun on enemies who approach her down the hallway. If near death, she tries to escape through a door, leaving the encounter.

The sweepers use their shrikeguns to push enemies into burning rubble.

The war dog phosphorites and war dog sharpshooters start the encounter on the gallery. The phosphorites use pillars for cover.

The war dog eviscerites start the encounter near the malfunctioning teleporter pad. They use their chainsaw whips to pull creatures into the malfunctioning teleporter pad and other hazards.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when the Condemned leave the area via one of the doors in the Access Corridor. Heroes earn 1 Victory for this encounter.

> Sidebar: Teleportation in the Crysopolis
>
> Lord Ajax keeps tight control of comings and going on the Crysopolis. Long-distance teleportation functions only with the aid of teleportation pads like the one in the War Dog Teleportation Hub. Features like the elementalist's Distance Is Only Memory always fail. However, short-distance teleportation abilities, like the elementalist's Grasp of Beyond, work normally.

Stat Blocks

Flaming debris [renamed lava stat block]

War dog doomthief

War dog eviscerite

War dog phosphorite

War dog sharpshooter

War dog sweeper

Escaping the War Dog Facility

Once the Condemned have defeated or evaded the war dogs, Gerold tells them, "This is one of Ajax's military facilities. It's swarming with war dogs. We've got to get out of here." If the players have further questions, he replies: "We have no time for chat! Hurry!"

To escape the facility, the heroes must sneak, fight, or race their way through a building swarming with war dog patrols. Run this as a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test (described below).

Crysopolis Alarm Level

Read or paraphrase the following:

- "You are in the Crysopolis, a flying fortress city patrolled by Ajax's troops. Just moving around the city is dangerous!"
- "Whenever you do anything to attract attention, travel becomes even more dangerous until you find a way to reduce the heat."
- "Crysopolis's current level of alert is represented by its alarm level, a number that is always between 0 and 5."
- "There's a place for you to keep track of the alarm level on Handout: The Crysopolis."
- "Note the starting alarm level on the handout. The alarm level is currently 0, or 1 if any war dogs from the War Dog Teleportation Hub survived. I'll tell you whenever the alarm level changes."

Montage Test: Crysopolis Infiltration

[NOTE: This entire section is reused several times. It is summarized in Director Reference: Crysopolis Infiltration Montage Test.]

To move around restricted areas in Crysopolis (for instance, to exit the War Dog Teleportation Hub room), the Condemned must make a **Crysopolis Infiltration montage test**. This is a special, repeated montage test that the Condemned may face when they enter or leave a restricted location in Crysopolis. This adventure will tell you whenever the story requires a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test.

This montage test is one round long, or two rounds if the party consists of three or fewer characters.

If the montage test is one round long, the party achieves total success if they hit the success limit, achieve partial success if time runs out with at least one success, and fail if they hit the failure limit.

Crysopolis Infiltration Test Difficulty

Heroes	Success Limit	Failure Limit
Three	3	3
Four	2	2
Five	3	2
Six	3	3

Montage Challenges

The following challenges can be part of the montage test:

Avoid Traffic: By sticking to the least-traveled areas, the Condemned avoid notice. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Navigate, Search, Track.

Case Out (not available while leaving an objective): The Condemned learn guard schedules and acquire blueprints. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Alertness, Architecture, Eavesdrop, Navigate, Pick Pocket.

Demolition (not available while entering an objective): The Condemned blast their way out. This activity doesn't require a test; it automatically succeeds, but it raises the alarm level by 1 and the character must spend a blackpowder grenade.

Go Off Script (not available while leaving an objective): Instead of helping with the mission, the character indulges in some petty act of villainy or mayhem. This activity counts as a failure. The party gains a Hero Token. *Special:* This challenge can be taken any number of times.

Lie Low (not available while entering an objective): The Condemned find a place to hide for a bit. *Suggested Characteristics:* Agility. *Suggested Skills:* Hide, Sneak.

Make a Diversion: After causing a ruckus, the Condemned quickly go the other way. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Alchemy, Lift, Perform, Sabotage.

Make Criminal Contacts (not available while leaving an objective): The Condemned find shady people who lead them by hidden ways. *Suggested Characteristic:* Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Criminal Underworld, Rumors.

Perform Magic: A character uses magic to teleport the party, melt a wall, turn invisible, gather information, or perform a similar magical feat, provided the Narrator judges that it would be helpful to do so. The character must spend any resources necessary to use the ability. This activity doesn't require a test.

Pose as Guards: Using stolen uniforms lets the Condemned move freely through the city. The test for this challenge gains an edge if the characters defeated war dog guards during their infiltration. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Disguise, Lie, Search.

Question Gerold: The protagonists threaten or sweet-talk Gerold into choosing the best route. *Suggested Characteristic:* Might, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Empathize, Flirt, Interrogate, Intimidate, Persuade. *Special:* This activity automatically succeeds if the protagonist gives Gerold a bottle of Riojan Gold or another good wine.

Skulk in the Shadows: The Condemned keep out of sight. *Suggested Characteristic:* Agility. Suggested Skills: Hide, Sneak. *Special:* The heroes can attempt this challenge twice during the montage test.

Take Out a Sentry: The Condemned assassinate a sentry in their way, opening a path. *Suggested Characteristic:* Might, Agility. *Suggested Skills:* Gymnastics, Hide, Jump, Sneak.

Montage Test Outcomes:

One of the following outcomes ends the montage test:

Total Success: The heroes reach their goal.

Partial Success: The heroes reach their goal, but the alarm level of the Crysopolis goes up by 1.

Total Failure: The heroes reach their goal, but the alarm level of the Crysopolis goes up by 2. Additionally, they encounter a patrol.

- If the alarm level is 2, the Condemned encounter a War Dog Squad (see below).
- If the alarm level is 3, the Condemned encounter a War Dog Patrol (see below).
- If the alarm level is 4 or higher, the Condemned encounter a War Dog Strike Team (see below).

If the Condemned want to avoid combat, they can spend a number of intel equal to the current alarm level to give an appropriate password. Otherwise, they must fight the patrol.

Montage Test Combat Encounters:

Failures during a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test can lead to combats with a war dog squad, patrol, or strike team. These encounter groups are presented below. Each combat takes place on your choice of the Crysopolis Road map or the War Dog Facility map (see below), and they don't provide Victories.

War Dog Squad

Group	Creatures
1	Two war dog sparkslingers per hero (minion squad)

War Dog Patrol

Group	Creatures
1	One war dog equivite per character
2	Two war dog sweepers per character (minion squad)

War Dog Strike Team

Group	Creatures
1	One war dog hypokrite per character
2	Four war dog commandos per character, plus two extra war dog commando for each time the party previously fought a war dog strike team (minion squad)

Stat Blocks

War dog commando

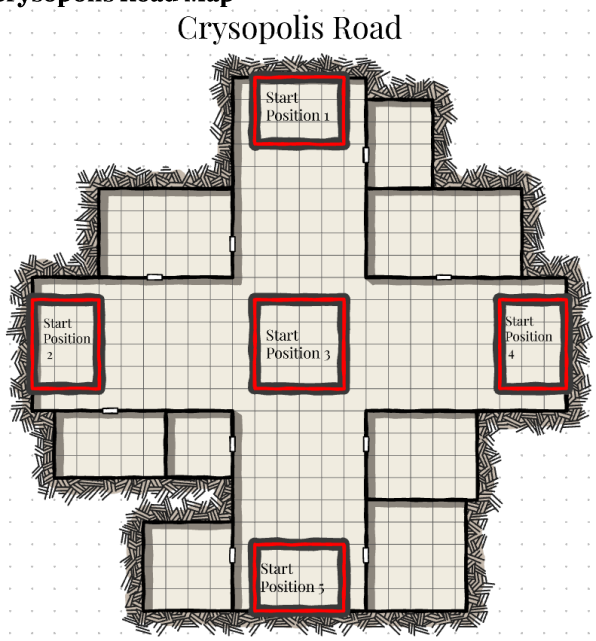
War dog equivite

War dog hypokrite

War dog sparkslinger

War dog sweeper

Crysopolis Road Map



The Crysopolis Road map represents an outdoor crossroads lined with buildings. Roll on the Crysopolis Road Starting Position table to determine the start positions of the following three groups: Condemned, war dogs, and civilians (reroll if a start position is already occupied).

Crysopolis Road Starting Position

Roll (1d10)	Start Position
1–2	Start position 1
3–4	Start position 2
5–6	Start Position 3
7–8	Start Position 4
9–10	Start Position 5

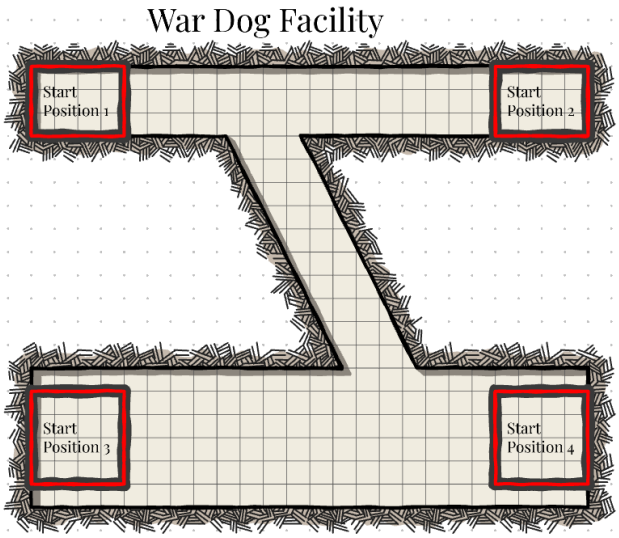
Condemned: The Condemned start in their chosen area. The encounter ends when the Condemned defeat all enemies or when they exit through any of the map's exits except the one they started in: the map edges next to Start Positions 1, 2, 4, or 5 (start position 3 is not an exit). Once a character has exited the map, they can't take turns.

Enemies: The enemies start in (or near) their chosen area. They stay in their start position until they spot the Condemned, moving to attack when they do so.

Civilians: 1d6 **noncombatants** start in their chosen area. They are too panicked to leave their spaces willingly.

Houses: The Condemned and enemies can enter the houses along the road. When the door to a house is opened for the first time, roll 1d6 and place that many noncombatants in the house.

War Dog Facility Map



The War Dog Facility map represents a section of a military base. Roll on the War Dog Facility Starting Position table to determine the start positions of the following two groups: Condemned and war dogs (reroll if a start position is already occupied).

War Dog Facility Starting Position

Roll (1d10)	Start Position
1–2	Start position 1
3–4	Start position 2
5–7	Start Position 3
8–10	Start Position 4

Condemned: The Condemned start in their chosen area. The encounter ends when the Condemned defeat all enemies or when they exit through any of the map's exits except the one they started in: the map edges next to Start Positions 1, 2, 3, or 4. Once a character has exited the map, they can't take turns.

Enemies: The enemies start in or near their chosen area and move to another area. Roll on the War Dog Facility Starting Position table to determine their destination (rerolling if their start position and destination are the same). On their turns, the war dogs move toward their destination until they spot the Condemned, attacking when they do so. If the enemies all reach their destination without spotting the Condemned, they exit the map and the encounter ends.

The Crysopolis Revealed

- "You pass through an unmarked door and emerge onto a bustling city street."
- "The passers-by are mostly human, but you see a few orcs, memonek, and elves, plus a war dog patrol that's not paying any attention to you at the moment."
- "Even though it's crowded, people are quiet and don't make eye contact."
- "The street slopes up towards a castle in the distance, and down towards—nothing. Blue sky and clouds. The city is an island floating in the air."

The Crysopolis is Ajax's floating fortress, but it's also a cosmopolitan capital city with all the amenities you'd expect in the capital of a powerful nation.

If asked for direction, Gerold says, "You're the big-shot expert team. Why don't you poke around and find some intel, that's what you're supposed to be doing here."

Gathering Intel

Read or paraphrase the following.

- "While exploring the Crysopolis, you'll be searching for information on your mission."
- "The team has an intel score, which represents the information you've gathered so far about the mission: passcodes, floor plans, contacts, and so on."
- "It also represents the non-mission-related information you've gathered: research on how to escape loyalty collars, join in potential criminal opportunities, and the like."
- "There's a place for you to keep track of your intel score on Handout: The Crysopolis."
- "You can spend intel, as summarized on the handout."
- "You may also find other ways to use intel, so keep some in reserve!"
- "Your starting intel score is 0, plus 1 for each coded document you saved from the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates. You can update your intel score now."

Spending Intel

A Condemned character can spend intel in the following way:

- **Costs 1 intel: Reroll.** When a character makes a test and doesn't like the outcome, they can reroll. They must use the new roll.

In addition, there are other opportunities to spend intel throughout the adventure.

Montage Test: Exploring the Lower City

During this section of the adventure, the Condemned can explore the lower, non-military part of the city, getting their bearings and picking up intel on their mission. They can also follow their own inclinations and get up to some villainous fun.

This city exploration is conducted as a montage test, where the nature of the test is determined by the location each character explores.

Let the players examine Handout: The Crysopolis to inspire their explorations. They can visit any area except the Underwalks and areas inside the Redoubt (they can visit High Street, Low Street, the Back Alleys, the Lower Docks, the Gambling District, or the Redoubt itself). The players can be guided by the locations available ("what can I do in the Back Alleys?") or by what they want to do ("where can I get some healing?")

> Sidebar: Bringing Crysopolis to Life
>
> Although the Condemned don't have much time for sightseeing (they're on the clock!) this montage test is a rare opportunity to explore the Crysopolis. If you enjoy improvising you should feel free to play out each successful challenge as a short scene. Let the players' activities inspire you to introduce new challenges, locations, minor NPCs, and follow-up opportunities that the party can explore. Doing so can give the Crysopolis the feel of living, breathing city, and it can make this section of the adventure feel like an opportunity for open-world exploration. Furthermore, it gives each of the Condemned a chance to put their quirks and personalities on display.
>
> If you're playing with pregenerated characters, don't forget that they each have a title that rewards them with a Hero Token for taking certain actions. This montage test is a good time for them to earn those Hero Tokens!

This montage test is two rounds long (although the Condemned can choose to spend a third round if they want to keep exploring).

> Sidebar: Crysopolis's Alarm Level
>
> Although the current alarm level has no effect on this montage challenge, you can make it feel like it does!
>
> As the party starts exploring the city, describe the city's mood and readiness level.
>
> **Alarm level 0 or 1:** "You pass ordinary people keeping their heads down and going about their business. War dog

patrols are chattering to each other, not paying much attention to their surroundings."

Alarm level 2 or 3: "War dog patrols roam the streets, occasionally stopping people and asking to see their ID. You hear people gossiping, wondering why the war dogs are out in force."

Alarm level 4 or 5: "War dog patrols are running up and down each street, and you barely avoid the random ID checks they're conducting. Repeated announcements echo from guard towers, warning citizens to be vigilant against traitors known to have infiltrated the city."

Exploring the City Test Difficulty

Heroes	Success Limit	Failure Limit
Three	4	3
Four	4	3
Five	5	4
Six	6	5

Montage Challenges

During this montage, the party members can split up, each one investigating the city in their own way. Visiting some locations grant extra benefits beyond success or failure on the chosen challenge. During this montage challenge, each location can be visited twice.

The following challenges can be part of the montage test:

Case Out the Redoubt: The protagonist heads "uptown" to the Redoubt, the giant, magically-protected wall that encloses the upper part of the city. (See The Redoubt Gate for more details on the wall.) The gates of the Redoubt are guarded by soldiers who check paperwork and passwords. The protagonist can't get inside right now, but they can try to climb, sneak, or bluff their way into places where they can overhear passwords. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Agility, Intuition, Persuasion. *Suggested Skills:* Architecture, Climb, Disguise, Eavesdrop, Forgery, Hide, Jump, Navigate, Pick Lock, Search, Sneak. *Special:* The first time a protagonist gains a success, they also overhear gossip between merchants: "Lord Ajax and his court are away, so you won't find any buyers at the Palace. I'm going to the Archivist. Say what you want about him, he's got the brains to recognize a good deal."

Cause Trouble in the Gambling District: The gambling district is where off-duty servants of Ajax cut loose. War dog patrols are notably absent, with each bar, gambling house, or fight club providing its own rough-and-tumble security. There's lots of information to be shaken out of drunk or off-guard locals. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Intuition, Persuasion. *Suggested Skills:* Brag, Disguise, Eavesdrop, Flirt, Gamble, Intimidate, Lie, Pick Pocket. *Special:* Instead of advancing the mission, the protagonist can get in on the fun, finding some beloved villainous activity to indulge in: gambling, robbery, arson, fight clubs, or the like. In this case, this montage challenge is an automatic failure but the protagonist regains two Recoveries and the party gains a Hero Token.

Collect Gossip on High Street: High Street looks like an ordinary high-class shopping district, although the wares for sale include military ordnance that would be forbidden in most other cities. Here the protagonist mingles with the more well-off members of Ajax's organization, including mob bosses and disreputable noble families. *Suggested Characteristics:* Reason, Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Alertness, Criminal Underworld, Eavesdrop, Flirt, Forgery, Navigate, Search, Society, Pick Pocket. *Special:* The first time a protagonist gains a success, they hear gossip between nobles: "ADVANCE is the war dogs' problem now. Apparently it's quite the handful." Additionally, whether or not the montage challenge succeeds, the protagonist finds a market for discriminating buyers. The Condemned can spend 1 intel to acquire their choice of the following: a) four blackpowder grenades of any variety (see Handout: Experimental Gear), or b) four bottles of Riojan Gold wine (see Gerold's Head), to a maximum of 12 of each. Gerold votes for the wine.

Exchange Secrets in the Back Alleys: The back alleys house black markets, gangs, and purveyors of dubious information. There might be some good info to be found here. *Suggested Characteristics:* Reason, Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Criminal Underworld, Disguise, Eavesdrop, Hide, Lie, Persuade, Rumors. *Special:* The first time a protagonist gains a success, they hear gossip between smugglers: "My dwarf buddy in Low Street knows a way to get into the Redoubt without all the... paperwork." Additionally, whether or not the montage challenge succeeds, the protagonist finds a sketchy doctor who is willing to treat wounds with experimental procedures. The protagonist can spend one intel to gain four syringes (to a maximum of 12 syringes). Syringes are a consumable treasure equivalent to healing potions.

Find a Chop Shop in the Lower Docks: Small flying vehicles unload goods at the lower docks; war dogs swarm the vessels, thoroughly inspecting them for contraband. At the docks the protagonist can track down fences, mechanics, or tech experts—maybe looking for new weapons, maybe a used airship, maybe looking for ways to get out of their loyalty collars. *Suggested Characteristics:* Reason, Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Blacksmithing, Criminal Underworld, Jewelry, Lie, Mechanics, Persuade, Rumors. *Special:* Whether or not the montage challenge succeeds, the protagonist can choose to get a lead on an airship, loyalty collar information, or how to get past the Redoubt. **If they choose airship information,** they learn that every airship is thoroughly inpected for stowaways—except for ships taking off from the Sky Harbor inside the Redoubt. **If they choose loyalty collar information,** they learn that someone called the Archivist in the Record Control building knows how to remove loyalty collars. **If they choose Redoubt information**, they learn that dwarves in Low Street can bypass the Redoubt to perform their repairs.

The protagonists learns all three pieces of information if they visit this location twice.

Question Gerold: The protagonists threaten or sweet-talk Gerold into coughing up some extra information. *Suggested Characteristic:* Might, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Empathize, Flirt, Interrogate, Intimidate, Persuade. *Special:* This activity automatically succeeds if the protagonist gives Gerold a bottle of Riojan Gold or another good wine. *Special:* In addition to a success on the montage test, Gerold shares a relevant piece of information of the Director's choice (see Gerold's Head). For instance, if the party is banged up, Gerold suggests they go to the back alleys and look for some healing.

Snoop Around Low Street: Low Street is the grimy slum housing the city's workers. Dwarves are well-represented among its population. Here the protagonist questions locals, eavesdrops on their conversations, reads the broadsheets posted around the city, or looks for information on military projects. *Suggested Characteristics:* Agility, Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Brag, Criminal Underworld, Culture, Eavesdrop, Empathize, Flirt, Gamble, Hide, Jump, Lie, Persuade, Sneak, Rumors. *Special:* On a success, the protagonist sees a team of dwarf engineers entering a sewer access tunnel, quietly discussing the repairs they need to make beyond the Redoubt. The protagonist learns how to enter this tunnel.

Montage Test Outcomes:

One of the following outcomes ends the montage test:

Total Success: The party's intel score increases by 5 and the alarm level of the Crysopolis decreases by 1. The heroes gain 1 Victory each.

Partial Success: The party's intel score increases by 3. The heroes gain 1 Victory each.

Total Failure: The alarm level of the Crysopolis increases by 1 and the party's intel score increases by 1. The heroes gain 1 Victory each.

Additionally, on a success or failure, the party learns that all military research projects are coordinated by the Record Control department. The Record Control building is inside the Redoubt.

Getting Inside the Redoubt

To access Record Control, the Condemned will have to enter the Redoubt.

The most obvious way to get inside the Redoubt is by the front gate. From their investigations, the Condemned may also have learned that they can use the sewers in Low Street to bypass the Redoubt. Depending on where they want to go next, go to The Redoubt Gate or Entering the Sewers (or let them revisit other lower city locations, if they want to buy more items in High Street or the Back Alleys for instance).

The Redoubt Gate

- "The Redoubt is a high, glass-smooth wall circling the inner part of the city."
- "The top of the wall is patrolled by war dogs and bristling with ballistas pointing down at you."
- "All traffic goes through big gates. War dog guards ask everyone for passwords and paper documents."
- "Pinned above each gate is a broadsheet: 'Wanted for sabotage of a teleportion hub.' There are somewhat inaccurate sketches of each of you. You're honestly not sure whether you could be recognized from these broadsheets."

> Sidebar: No Security is Perfect
>
> Besides its overwhelming military defenses, the Redoubt is magically protected: teleportation is impossible into or out of the Redoubt, and its glassy surface is too slippery to climb. Even with all its defenses, it's possible that a party may find an unexpected way into the Redoubt: perhaps they can all fly, for instance. If their plan is plausible, give it a chance to succeed (in which case you can skip to Safe Harbor). However, if the attempt fails, the alarm level is raised by 1.

To enter the Redoubt by the front gate, the Condemned will have to spend their intel on passcodes and documentation. The cost to enter the city is 6 intel plus the current Crysopolis alarm level (a maximum intel cost of 11).

The Condemned can reduce this cost by up to 3 points by clever use of their skills, abilities, and other assets. No tests are required for these efforts. Examples:

- One protagonist with the Forgery skill can reduce the cost by 1 by falsifying documents.
- One protagonist with Lie or a similar skill can reduce the cost by an additional 1 by bluffing the guards.
- One protagonist with the Disguise skill or with the ability to magically disguise their appearance can reduce the cost by an additional 1 by masquerading as an official or by disguising the other Condemned.

If the Condemned are able and willing to pay the Intel cost to enter the Redoubt, go to Into the Redoubt. If the Condemned can't or won't enter the Redoubt this way, they can try the Redoubt's sewer entry (Gerold suggests this course if the Condemned haven't discovered the sewers). Go to Entering the Sewers.

Into the Redoubt

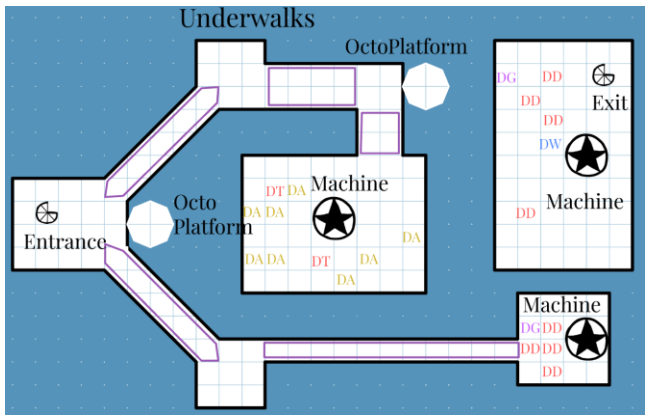
- "You pass through the gate. As a guard is about to stamp your passes into the Redoubt, you hear an ear-splitting roar, like continous thunder."
- "A vast metal object—like a tremendous ship with no masts—is slowly settling inside the Redoubt."
- "Around the vessel are scores of smaller vessels and warriors riding giant hawks."
- "The guard with the stamp is momentarily distracted, looking away from you to watch the flying ship. As he looks back down at you, his gaze falls on the wanted poster with your illustrations."
- "He gives you a long look... and then finally stamps your papers. 'You're free to enter the Redoubt.'"

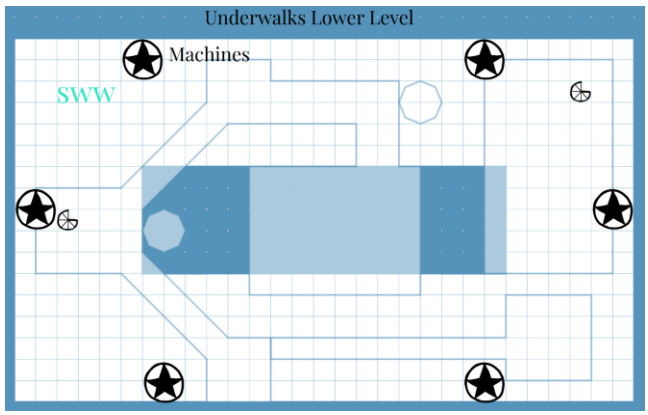
The Condemned are inside the Redoubt. Each character gains 1 Victory.

Skip the Entering the Sewers section of the adventure and go to Safe Harbor.

Combat or Negotiation: Entering the Sewers

- "You go to Low Street and enter the sewer entrance that's supposed to lead past the Redoubt gate."
- "It doesn't look like a sewer down here: it's way too clean. Rickety metal ladders and sloped passages lead down and down."
- "Finally, you climb down a metal ladder and emerge into the light of day. You're on a metal platform in the sky. Above you is a ceiling of unworked stone: the bottom of the flying island of the Crysopolis."
- "The ladder continues down to a lower platform. Below the lower platform are wisps of clouds, and below that, distant ocean."
- "Ahead, catwalks lead toward a ladder going up, presumably leading somewhere else in Crysopolis."
- "Dwarves bustle about the platforms, working on machinery. They're standing between you and the ladder up."





Getting the Drop On the Dwarves

The party can make a hard group Agility test to sneak to an advantageous tactical position. On a failure, the Condemned must start the encounter on the entrance platform. On a success, the Condemned can position themselves in any spaces not on the Underwalks Lower Level and not within 4 squares of a flying machine, and if the Condemned immediately start combat the dwarves are surprised.

Spotted by the Dwarves

When the dwarves spot the Condemned, they draw weapons and shout "This is a restricted area!" The Condemned can try to bluff, negotiate, or fight their way past.

Bluffing By the Dwarves

If at least one of the Condemned is disguised as a Crysopolis authority figure, such as a war dog officer, that character can make a medium Presence test to explain away their presence.

- **≤11:** The dwarves aren't deceived and attack the Condemned.
- **12-16:** The Condemned must bolster their bluff with passwords and other insider knowledge. The Condemned can spend 3 intel to deceive the dwarves; otherwise they must negotiate or fight.
- **17+:** The Condemned deceive the dwarves.

If the Condemned successfully deceive the dwarves, they earn 1 Victory each and can climb the stairs to the Crysopolis's surface. Go to Safe Harbor.

Negotiating With the Dwarves

The dwarf warden is the head of this engineering team, responsible for the flying devices that let the dwarves inspect the island's underside. She'll be punished if she lets unauthorized people through her zone, but she's willing to let the Condemned by without a fight if they can give her a good reason.

The dwarves keep their head down and do their work, ignoring rumors from the outside world. The Condemned can't use their Renown during this negotiation.

The Dwarf Warden Negotiation Stats

Interest: 2 **Patience:** 3 **Impression:** 3

Native Language: Zaliac

Motivations

- **Freedom:** The warden isn't particularly excited about working for Ajax; judging by their loyalty collars, the strangers aren't either. There really isn't much of a reason for slaves to fight to the death for their masters' profit.
- **Peace:** The warden and her team have a somewhat enjoyable assignment doing interesting work. They'd rather be back at work rather than wasting their time throwing interlopers off the island.

Pitfall

Vengeance: The warden isn't looking for trouble with Ajax or anyone else.

This negotiation can have the following outcomes:

Interest 4 or 5: The dwarves let the Condemned pass. Furthermore, the warden takes a protagonist aside. "Listen, you have to do what the collars say but you don't have to do *everything* they say." The warden gives some technical advice on circumventing the collars. The party gains 2 intel.

Interest 3: The dwarves let the Condemned pass.

Interest 2 or lower: The dwarves attack.

Negotiation Victories

If the Condemned use negotiation to avoid combat with the dwarves, they earn 1 Victory each and can climb the stairs to the Crysopolis's surface. Go to Safe Harbor.

Fighting the Dwarves

If combat breaks out, use the Underwalks and Underwalks Lower Level map to run this encounter. The upper catwalks and platforms are suspended 3 squares below the ceiling, and the lower level is suspended 3 squares below that.

> Sidebar: Certain Death
>
> A creature that falls from a platform or catwalk faces certain death unless they land on a lower platform or have a way to fly. But don't fret! Soon after this encounter, players that lose a character will have the opportunity to gain a new one (see Meeting Khavettra.)

Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

Underwalks Groups

Group	Creatures
1	**Dwarf gunner** (captain) **Four dwarf drivers** (minion squad)
2	**Dwarf gunner** (captain) **Four dwarf drivers** (minion squad)
3	**Dwarf trapper**(captain) **Four dwarf axethrowers** (minion squad)
4	**Dwarf trapper** (captain) **Four dwarf axethrowers** (minion squad)
5	**Dwarf warden**
6	**Servitor War Walker**

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add one **one dwarf warden** to Group 5 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove **group 2** at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove **group 2 and group 4** at the start of the encounter.

Catwalks

The catwalks (outlined in purple) helpfully shift underfoot, accelerating movement. It costs half a square of movement to enter a square of catwalk.

Flying Machines

The dwarves are working on these machines, which are part of a system that allows flight around Crysopolis. A creature within 10 squares can spend 1 intel to know how the machines work.

While adjacent to a machine, a creature can use a maneuver to gain the ability to fly until the end of the encounter. Each machine can be used once on each turn, and any number of times during a round.

Each machine has 20 Stamina.

Octo Platforms

These two octagonal platforms are flying cargo carriers. At the start of the encounter, each platform is at the location marked on the map. At the end of the first round and each odd-numbered round, the platform travels to the right, carrying any creatures and objects aboard, stopping when it touches the platform to the right. At the end of each even-numbered round, the platform travels back to its starting position.

Platforms

Each platform floats in space, unattached to the rocky ceiling above except by the entrance and exit ladders.

Stairs

Each of the two sets of stairs extend from the underwalk lower level, up to the main level where the Condemned first appear, and up from there into the Crysopolis.

Underwalks Lower Level

The lower level catwalks form a hollow square. The only features on the lower levels are the two stairs and six flying machines. The servitor war walker patrols this level.

Tactics

Whenever a group of dwarves starts their turn, one member of that group adjacent to a flying machine can use the machine to gain flight.

The dwarves use their forced movement abilities to push foes off ledges. Dwarves with melee attacks pile on octo platforms or fly to reach foes, while ranged attackers hang back, using flight to evade melee attackers. If a protagonist falls onto the lower level, the dwarves stay above, shooting down at them.

The servitor war walker on the lower level stays on the lower level, walking an endless clockwise circuit. It never attacks creatures on the upper level. When a non-dwarf enters or lands on the lower level, the war walker moves toward them and attacks, keeps their foe permanently restrained, and drags them along when they move. The war walker ignores dwarf Condemned.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when the Condemned go up the stairs on the right side of the map (the dwarves do not follow). If the heroes fight their way through the dwarves, they gain 1 Victory each and can climb the stairs to the Crysopolis's surface. Go to Safe Harbor.

Stat Blocks

Dwarf axethrower

Dwarf driver

Dwarf gunner

Dwarf trapper

Dwarf warden

Servitor war walker

Safe Harbor

- "You find yourselves in the back streets beyond the Redoubt."
- "On the skyline you can see the city's sky harbor and the giant vessel you saw land."
- "You pass a wanted poster: 'Wanted for sabotage of a teleportion hub', with your illustrations."
- "Far down the street you see a war dog patrol. They approach, weapons ready."

Although the war dogs (a War Dog Strike Team, see the Crysopolis Infiltration montage test) are still out of combat range (50 squares away), give the players a few seconds to prepare for combat, negotiation, or flight. Before they take decisive action, a new figure comes on the scene.

Meeting Khavettra

- "Behind the war dog patrol, a memonek wearing an unfamiliar military uniform comes running down the street, yelling to get the war dogs' attention. 'There's a disturbance near the Palace! Head there on the double!'"
- "The war dogs salute and run out of the alley, leaving you alone with the newcomer."
- "The memonek raises his hands and approaches. 'My name is Khavettra. I think we have a mutual enemy.'"

Khavettra is an anti-Ajax rebel who has learned of the Condemned infiltration attempt. He wants to help them—although the Condemned have every right to be suspicious of his convenient arrival!

If the Condemned brush Khavettra off or attack him, he makes one more effort to convince him of his good intentions and then retreats, giving up on the Condemned. Khavettra's aid is useful, but the players can go it alone if they want.

If the Condemned argue about whether to trust Khavettra or not, this might be time for a Power Grab (see the Introduction).

If the Condemned question Khavettra, they can learn the following:

- **Questioned About the Asset:** "I haven't been particularly tracking Ajax's military research—to UNISOL, one primitive weapon is much like another. But if there's restricted information you want, they'll know about it in the Record Control building. The Archivist is the spider at the center of the web. He's on the top floor."
- **Questioned About Himself:** "I'm not from this world. I'm from an upperworld peacekeeping organization called UNISOL. I act as Ajax's harbormaster here, supplying vessels like that heavy cruiser you can see in the sky harbor."
- **Questioned About His Motives:** "I joined UNISOL to protect the timescape, but UNISOL sold out this world when it made a deal with this local thug Ajax. I'd rather see Ajax deposed than in charge, which is why I'm part of the resistance in this city."
- **Questioned About His Convenient Arrival:**
- **If the players arrived via the Redoubt gate:** "One of my men stamped your entrance visas to the Redoubt. He let me know to be on the watch for you."
- **If the players fought the dwarves in the sewers:** "As harbormaster, I was notified of a disturbance in the underwalks. I guessed you were Capital spies trying to break into the Redoubt."
- **If the players negotiated with the dwarves in the sewers:** "The warden of the underwalks is sympathetic to the cause. She said you might need help."
- **Questioned About How He Can Help:** "I might be able to line up an escape route. As harbormaster, I can give shore leave to the crew of my UNISOL cruiser, and then I can smuggle you on board. Contact me when you've finished your mission and you're ready to go."
- **Questioned About the Local Resistance:** "There are a few other people in Crysopolis who don't like Ajax, and we've banded together. Naturally I won't risk any of you by putting you in touch, but I might be able to help you in other ways: transportation, for instance."

Khaeattra is exactly what he says he is: a UNISOL officer and the local leader of the resistance against Ajax. If the party decides to work with Khavettra, they gain several benefits:

- Khavetra gives the party passcodes they'll need to get around the Redoubt. The party's intel score increases by 3.
- Khavettra can point them to a safehouse where they can take a Respite if they want. (Keep in mind the party only has time for 1 Respite during their 48-hour mission!) Khavettra then leaves, heading back to his office in the sky harbor.
- Khavettra gives the party a **chatbox** so they can stay in touch.

Chatbox

This warm, fist-sized metal box pulsates quietly as if it contained a heart.

Effect: While holding the chatbox, you can communicate telepathically with Khavettra. Besides allowing conversation, this telepathic communication gives you an edge on tests that use the Drive, Mechanics, Society, and Timescape skills.

Sidebar: Making New Characters

If one or more of the characters have died, or if a player just wants to try a new character, Khavettra can provide new recruits from his spy organization. These new characters can be any class or pregenerated character, with the following modifications:

- If you use one of the pregenerated characters from this adventure, they lose that character's backstory, complication, and title.
- The character has the Faction Member title. The faction is UNISOL, and it is treated as a guild faction for the purposes of the Faction Member title.

The adventure's protagonists are still the Condemned, even if they have some goody-two-shoes UNISOL agents among them!

Montage Test: Accessing Record Control

Like most of the military buildings in the Crysopolis fortress, Record Control is a heavily guarded, multistory building. The most sensitive records are kept on the top floor.

The Condemned must make a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test to enter the facility and reach the top floor (see Montage Test: Crysopolis Infiltration).

Negotiation or Combat: Record Control

- "You make it to the top floor of Record Control."
- "Before you is a door that says "Archivist's Office."
- Once the heroes open the door: "The vast library beyond is lit only by candelabras near the door. The far side is dark. The walls are lined with shelves of odd objects."
- "Tables are covered with books, papers, and strange devices."
- "You hear a voice in your heads: 'This one is overdue.' Gerold is ripped away from you and flies across the room, disappearing into a slot marked 'Returns'."

The team can fight the Archivist, but if they'd rather negotiate, the Archivist is listening.

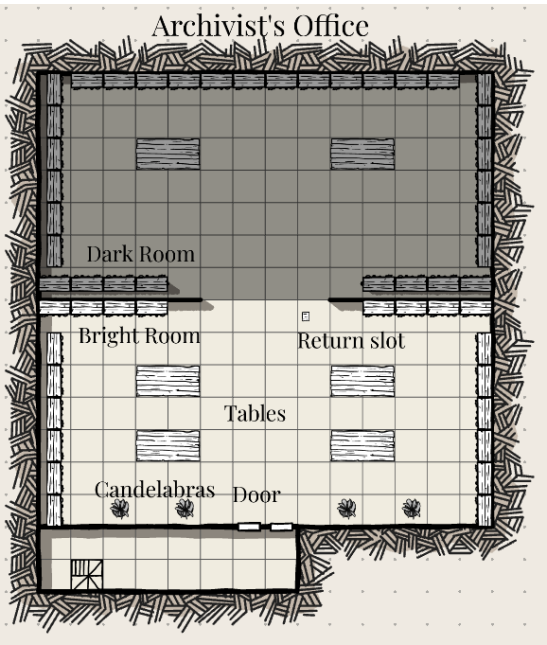
Sidebar: Content Warning: Body Horror

The descriptions of the Archivist's shelves and devices include body horror, which can be a theme that makes some players uncomfortable. Feel free to change the objects on the Archivists's shalves and tables to ordinary books and mechanical devices.

Sidebar: Exit Gerold

Gerold will return as an antagonist later in the adventure, so there's no saving him now: it's time for him to leave the party.

If Gerold is already gone (for instance, the party dropped him off the Underwalks or otherwise misplaced him), no worries: just skip his retrieval by the Archivist. He can still return later.



Negotiating With the Archivist

Run this section if the Condemned try to bargain with the Archivist. Depending on the party's level of commitment to the mission, they might ask for either information about the ADVANCE asset or for the secret of removing loyalty collars (or both!)

The Archivist (voiceless talker; he/him) is the head of Ajax's record-keeping division in the Record Control building. Information from Ajax's spies goes into Record Control, and the Archivist produces reports for Ajax to read (based on the spies' reports and the results of the Archivist's subtle telepathic probings). The Archivist knows the location and the nature of the ADVANCE asset.

As a repository of information, the Archivist keeps tabs on the wider world. The Condemned can use their Renown during this negotiation.

As the negotiation begins, read or paraphrase the following.

- "The voice echoes in your heads. 'You seek an exchange of information? You wish to ADVANCE your knowledge?'"
- "'I know quite a bit about the people you work for. But I don't know you.'"
- "'And I've been unable to track down the pesky rebels in the Crysopolis. Perhaps you know something about them, hmm?'"

The Archivist Negotiation Stats

Interest: 2 **Patience:** 2 **Impression:** 4

Native Language: Mindspeech

Motivations

- **Discovery:** The Archivist is happy working for Ajax, but his primary motive is gathering information, not serving some local despot. The Archivist will trade info with anybody if the price is right.
- **Freedom:** The Archivist has a nagging worry that Ajax may one day grow too powerful to be defied. The Archivist wants to remain Ajax's ally, not become his servant.

Pitfalls

Benevolence and Justice: "Don't insult me with your mammal-brained delusions of communal good."

During this negotiation, in addition to other negotiation tactics, heroes who provide the following pieces of information gain extra benefits.

- A Condemned character can reveal their criminal backstory to appeal to the Archivist's Discovery motivation. Once they have done so, the Archivist has an edge on any future power rolls made against this character.
- A character can reveal that Khavettra is part of the resistance against Ajax. This counts as a tier 3 outcome on a test. Unless the Condemned kill the Archivist, Khavettra then disappears from the rest of the adventure. If the party has Khavettra's talk box, it no longer functions.
- The Archivist is willing to buy information. Once during the negotiation, a character can spend 2 intel. This counts as a tier 3 outcome on a test.
- If the party contains any characters from Khavettra's resistance, another protagonist can reveal that character is part of the resistance. This appeals to the Archivist's Discovery motivation, even if it has already been appealed to. The archivist says to the resistance character, "You can go for now, but we'll be spending time together soon." The Archivist has an edge on any future power rolls made against this character.
- If a character tries to give information about Gerold, the Archivist says, "Oh, Gerold and I are old friends. But thank you for returning him on time. The late fees would be quite... punishing." This doesn't require a roll and counts as neither a success nor a failure.

This negotiation can have the following outcomes:

Interest 5: "This has been a very educational chat. Here: information must be paid for." The Archivist gives the Condemned a **thief of joy** and a **scroll of resurrection.** (The scroll requires a resurrected creature's head to be attached and intact—it can't be used to get out of a loyalty collar!)

Furthermore, the Archivist gives the Condemned the information they ask for.

- if the Condemned ask for information on the ADVANCE project, the Archivist gives them a schematic map of the Crysopolis Armory, pointing to a specific room. "ADVANCE research is conducted here." If asked further questions, in exchange for 1 intel the Archivist says, "The ADVANCE project is producing barrels and barrels of a rather volatile powder. I'd be careful about lighting a match while you're in there. "
- If the Condemned ask about removing their loyalty collars, the Archivist says, "Removing them:? Not something Lord Ajax has ever had cause to do. But you'll find the tools you need in any well-equipped UNISOL installation." If asked further questions, in exchange for 1 intel the Archivist mentions that the UNISOL heavy cruiser, currently docked at the Sky Harbor, is empty while its crew enjoys shore leave..

After the negotiation, the Condemned can either leave Record Control peacefully (go to Part 3) or double-cross the Archivist and attack him (go to Fighting the Archivist).

Interest 4: As Interest 5, but the Archivist does not give the thief of joy, and if the Condemned asked about information on both the ADVANCE asset and their loyalty collars, they must choose one or the other.

Interest 3: As Interest 4, but the Archivist gives neither the thief of joy nor the scroll of resurrection.

Interest 2 or lower: "This has been entertaining, but I don't think you know enough to be useful." The Archivist initiates combat. Go to Fighting the Archivist.

Victories

If the Condemned end the negotiation with the Archivist's Interest at 3 or higher and don't proceed to combat, they each earn 2 Victories.

Fighting the Archivist

Run this section if the Condemned fight the Archivist. Use the Archivist's Office map to run this encounter. The archive's ceilings are 3 squares high.

Groups

The following enemy appears in this encounter.

Voiceless Talker Archivist

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, the archivist has 360 Stamina and can take two maneuvers on each of his turns.
- For four heroes, the archivist has 240 Stamina.
- For three heroes, the archivist has 180 Stamina and can't use the Solo Action Malice feature.

Candelabras

Each candelabra sheds light for 6 squares. An adjacent creature can use a maneuver to snuff, light, pick up, or put down a candelabra, potentially changing the lighting conditions in the room.

Return Slot

A one-foot square trap door, marked "Returns", leads to a narrow tunnel. Anything or anyone that enters the slot is sucked into a patrolled area of Record Control, leaving the adventure (although Gerold will return later).

Shelves

Inside the office, the walls are lined with shelves that are 1 square wide and 3 squares tall. Each shelf is filled with a seemingly unsorted collection of books, scrolls, heads in jars, crystals, blinking devices, and mysterious organic lumps dripping off the shelves. Some of the objects seem vaguely alive but none can communicate.

A shelf has 10 Stamina. When destroyed, it falls, causing the following effect:

Falling Shelf

Area	No action
3 line (directly away from the wall)	Special

Effect: Each creature in the area takes 5 damage, plus 3 fire damage if the shelf is on fire. A creature who has Might < 2 is prone. The area becomes difficult terrain.

If a shelf takes fire damage it catches fire and several of the heads in jars and organic lumps start screaming. At the end of each round, each shelf adjacent to a flaming shelf also catches on fire.

A flaming shelf sheds light for 3 squares. When a creature is force moved into a flaming shelf, the creature takes an extra 3 fire damage.

When a flaming shelf is destroyed and falls, it is no longer on fire. A creature can use a maneuver to extinguish a flaming shelf.

Work Tables

Each work table is covered with books, papers, and devices. A table is difficult terrain.

On each table is one device (which is destroyed if the table is destroyed). The devices combine technological and organic elements (such as wires, tubes, panels of glowing numbers, beating hearts, veins, and skin). A device's purpose can't be determined unless it is picked up and activated as a maneuver or a creature spends an intel. Roll on the Random Library Device table when a device is activated.

A table has 15 Stamina. If a table takes damage but is not destroyed, the device on the table is automatically activated.

Random Library Device (roll 1d6)

1 When the device is activated, it starts beeping. At the end of the turn, the trinket explodes, dealing 10 fire damage to each creature in its or an adjacent square.
2 When the device is activated, it starts reading a book aloud: ancient Vastariax poetry. It continues reading for 1 day.
3 When the device is activated, it sets off an alarm. The alarm level increases by 1.
4 When the device is activated, it sheds light for 10 squares for 1 minute.
5 When the device is activated, it emits a telepathic scream. Each creature within 5 squares takes 10 psychic damage. The item is then destroyed.
6 When the device is activated, it telepathically communicates with each creature within 10 squares. Each turn is asks a question such as "Why was I made? What is my purpose? Are you my parent? When will this torment end?"

Tactics

When combat begins, half the room is shrouded in darkness, which doesn't hamper the voiceless talker archivist.

If the current alarm level is 0 to 2, or if the Condemned negotiated with the archivist before battle, the archivist starts in the lit half of the room and the Condemned go first.

Otherwise, the archivist starts in the dark half of the room and the archivist goes first. Before the archivist takes his first turn, the heroes hear his telepathic voice saying "You've caused quite a stir. I've been awaiting your arrival."

During combat, the archivist teleports around the area, using Tentacle Grab and Unstable Grenade and trying to end each turn in darkness.

If any bookshelves are destroyed or set on fire, the archivist becomes angry. He tries to use a maneuver each turn to extinguish a burning shelf.

If the heroes use fire or candelabras to light the dark half of the room, the archivist uses maneuvers to extinguish the light.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when the archivist is defeated. The heroes gain 2 Victories each.

Searching the archive, the Condemned find a file of papers referring to something called "The ADVANCE Project." Inside the file, the Condemned find a map of the Armory building pinpointing a specific room, along with lists of passcodes and equipment requisition forms. The party gains 2 intel from reading the file. (If all heroes have lost the ability to read due to the archivist's Mind Shatter ability, they can still read the map but don't gain the intel.)

The Condemned now have all the information they need to extract the asset. They can slip out of the Record Control building the same way they came in.

Loot

The archivist wears a **thief of joy** (which he does not use during the encounter). A careful search of the shelves reveals a **scroll of resurrection.** (The scroll requires a resurrected creature's head to be attached and intact—it can't be used to get out of a loyalty collar!)

Note: these items aren't present if the Condemned already earned them through negotiation!

Stat Blocks

[Voiceless Talker Malice: As in core book but the 3rd entry is as follows:]

Living Library (Maneuver) ◆ 7 Malice
Keywords Psionic
Distance Self **Target** Self
Effect Until the end of the encounter, all the objects on shelves become animated, flying from shelf to shelf and slamming into obstacles in their path. Any creature that starts their turn within 2 squares of a shelf takes 5 damage and is slid 3.

VOICELESS TALKER ARCHIVIST Level 3 Solo
HORROR, VOICELESS TALKER **EV 60**

1M	7	300	3	7
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Psychic 10 **Weakness:** —
Movement: Hover, teleport
M ight +1 A gility +2 R eason +3 I ntuition +3
P resence +2
d **Solo Monster**
End Effect: At the end of each of his turns, the archivist can take 5 damage to end one effect on him that can be ended by a saving throw. This damage can't be reduced in any way.
Solo Turns: The archivist can take two turns each round. He can't take turns consecutively.

r **Tentacle Grab** 2d10 + 3 **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon Main Action
e Melee 2 x Two creatures or objects
≤11 9 damage; A < 1 grabbed
12–16 13 damage; A < 2 grabbed
17+ 16 damage; A < 3 grabbed
2 Malice: The distance of this ability increases to melee 10. Each target grabbed by the archivist is pulled up to 10 squares.

r **Unstable Grenade** 2d10 + 3
Area, Psionic, Ranged Main Action
e 3 cube within 5 x Each creature or object in the area
≤11 The grenade misfires. It lands in the target's space, ticking ominously. A creature can pick it up and throw it as a main action. At the end of the round, it detonates, dealing 7 fire damage to each creature and object in a 1 burst.
12–16 7 fire damage
17+ 9 fire damage

r **Blow your Top** 2d10 + 3 **7 Malice**
Melee, Psionic, Strike Main Action
e Melee 1 x One grabbed enemy
≤11 10 fire damage
12–16 15 fire damage
17+ 19 fire damage
Effect: If this action reduces the target to 0 Stamina and they have a brain, their brain explodes, instantly killing them. Each creature and object within 2 squares of the target takes 5 fire damage.

r **You Come With Me**
Psionic Maneuver
e Self x Self
Effect: The archivist can teleport up to 5 squares along with each creature and object he has grabbed. He can release grabbed creatures and objects before or after teleporting.

! **You Philistine!**
— Triggered Action
e Ranged 10 x Self
Trigger: A shelf is destroyed or set on fire.
Effect: The archivist teleports to a square adjacent to the shelf and extinguishes it.

t **Reading In the Dark**
The archivist can see in the dark.

d **Telekinetic Book Toss** **Villain Action 1**
Psionic, Ranged, Strike, Weapon
e Ranged 10 x Three creatures or objects
≤11 6 damage; M < 1 prone
12–16 7 damage; M < 2 prone
17+ 8 damage; M < 3 prone
Effect: The target must be within 3 squares of a shelf or work table to be targeted by this ability. If the target is within 3 squares of a shelf or table that is on fire, the target takes an extra 3 fire damage.

r **Phantom Pain** **Villain Action 2**
Psionic
e Self x Self
Effect: The archivist becomes invisible, can teleport up to 10 squares, and projects an illusory double within 10 squares. If the archivist teleports to an area of darkness, he becomes hidden.
The double can't move or act, but the archivist can use psionic abilities as if he were in its square. Whenever a creature touches or damages the double with a melee strike, they take 10 psychic damage. If the archivist takes damage, his invisibility ends and the double disappears.

r **Mindshatter** **Villain Action 3**
Area, Psionic
e 5 burst x Each creature in the area
≤11 6 damage
12–16 9 damage
17+ 12 damage; the target loses the ability to read for 24 hours
Effect: Until the end of the encounter, each target has damage weakness 2.

PART 3: RESCUE THE ASSET

Advanced Research

At the start of this act, the Condemned have gathered a lot of information about the challenges ahead. They can either escape the Crysopolis without the ADVANCE asset (leaving the heroics to others and saving their own hides), or they can continue the mission (rescuing the asset and saving the world in the process).

To continue the mission, the Condemned must track down the ADVANCE asset. When they do, they'll discover that the asset is a scientist named Lady Letitia de Toera. She's working for Ajax unwillingly and is eager to join the team, after destroying her research. The Condemned must then steal the UNISOL heavy cruiser, escape the Crysopolis, and earn their freedom.

Abandoning the Mission

If the Condemned are a particularly independent, devious, or villainous group, they may have been looking for ways to get out of their loyalty collars from the very beginning—possibly at the expense of their actual mission. If this is the case, they may have learned that the UNISOL cruiser is the answer to their problems: aboard the cruiser, they can remove their loyalty collars and fly away from the Crysopolis. No need to complete de Caserta's mission!

Any decision to abandon the mission should be entirely self-directed by the players: you as Narrator don't need to suggest that the possibility even exists. But if the players put the pieces together, let them continue down this path if they wish. After all, the Condemned are not heroes: there's no expectation that they'll do the right thing! The Condemned attempting to escape a vengeful Ottavio de Caserta is one cool way their story can end—whether or not they succeed.

If the Condemned decide to head straight for the UNISOL cruiser, let them know that it's a one-way trip. Once they get aboard the cruiser, they're unlikely to be able to continue the mission: they'll have to blast off immediately.

If the Condemned opt to abandon the mission, they must make a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test to reach the Sky Harbor (see Montage Test: Crysopolis Infiltration). Once they have completed this montage test, skip forward to Combat: Sky Harbor Airfield.

Continuing the Mission

The Condemned now have the information they need to carry on with their mission. With the files they've obtained from Record Control, they now know exactly where the ADVANCE asset is being kept. They'll need to infiltrate the Armory.

Before they do, they have an opportunity to take a breather within the Redoubt. If they haven't yet taken a respite while in the Crysopolis, Khavettra or another local can direct them to a safe house where they can do so. (The Condemned only have time for one respite during this 48-hour mission!)

Montage Test: Entering the Armory

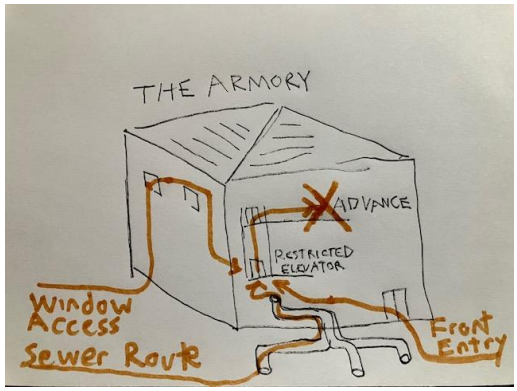
When the party is ready, give them Handout: Armory Schematic. This map was among the documents they obtained from Record Control. It shows three possible routes into the Armory: through the sewers, through a high window, and through the front door. Each route offers different challenges. Remember that a party disagreement could be an opportunity for a Power Grab (see the Introduction).

[Note: Handout: Armory Schematic

A blueprint-like but not very specific diagram of a square building with only a few windows. The diagram is marked with three entrances: Front Entry, Window Access, Sewer Route.

Inside the schematic, an elevator leads up to an X (as in X marks the spot) labeled ADVANCE.

Routes are drawn on the diagram, in a different color than the main schematic. Each route has arrows leading to the elevator, which then leads to the X.



]

Once the party is ready, they'll need to make a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test to enter the armory (see Montage Test: Crysopolis Infiltration). Depending on the route the party chose, the montage test starts with one of the new introductory challenges listed below. The first character to take a turn must attempt this introductory challenge. If they fail the challenge, the next character must either attempt the same challenge again or change routes, choosing a different introductory challenge. Once any character has succeeded on an introductory challenge, the rest of the montage test's challenges are chosen normally using the usual Crysopolis Infiltration challenge options.

Entering the Armory Introductory Challenge

If the party chose the sewer route, the following challenge is the first one in the montage test:
Wriggle Through the Sewers: The character leads the party through tight spaces while trying not to get lost. *Suggested Characteristics:* Agility, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Architecture, Endurance, Escape Artist, Navigate

If the party chose the window access, the following challenge is the first one in the montage test:
Climb the Armory: The character finds a route up the wall that is out of sight of guards. *Suggested Characteristics*: Might, Agility. *Suggested Skills*: Alertness, Architecture, Climb, Gymnastics, Sneak

If the party chose the front entry, the following challenge is the first one in the montage test:
Bluff Your Way In: The character convinces the guards that the team has a good reason for entering the armory. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Brag, Disguise, Empathize, Flirt, Forgery, Lie, Persuade, Society

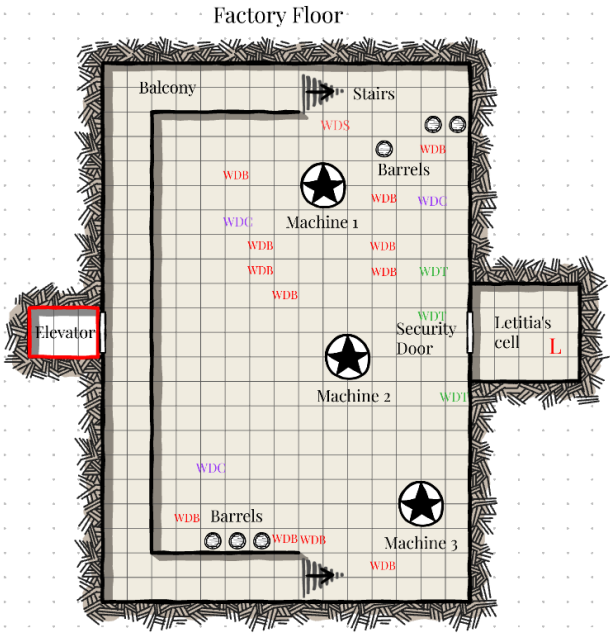
The Retricted Elevator

Once the Condemned complete the montage test, they find themselves at a glass elevator (the Restricted Elevator on the Armory schematic). They can spend 1 intel to enter the elevator's passcode, activating it. If they don't spend 1 intel, their efforts to use the elevator summon a War Dog patrol, which they must fight (see Crysopolis Infiltration Montage Test; the combat takes place on the War Dog Facility map, with Start Position 1 representing the locked elevator). After defeating the patrol, they gain a key which allows them to use the elevator.

Combat: Securing the Asset

- "The glass elevator takes you up to the balcony of a factory-like workroom."
- "Downstairs, war dog guards patrol the room."
- "The factory floor is covered with machines and barrels marked WARNING: EXPLOSIVE."
- "On the far side of the room is a heavy iron door ringed with red lights. According to the map, that's the location of the asset."
- **If the alarm level is 2 or lower:** "The guards don't notice you as you slip out of the elevator."
- **If the alarm level is 3 or higher:** "As the glass elevator's doors open, the guards look up at you, readying their weapons."

Use the Factory Floor map to run this encounter. The room's ceilings are 4 squares high.



Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

Factory Floor Groups

Group	Creatures
1	**War dog subcommander**
2	**Three war dog tormentites**
3	**War dog crucibite** (captain) **Four war dog blackpackers** (minion squad)
4	**War dog crucibite** (captain) **Four war dog blackpackers** (minion squad)
5	**War dog crucibite** (captain) **Four war dog blackpackers** (minion squad)

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add one **one war dog tormentite** to Group 2 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove **group 5** at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove **group 2** at the start of the encounter.

Balcony

The balcony is 2 squares above the floor and 2 squares above the ceiling. Each square of balcony has 10 Stamina. It has no railings.

Barrels

The barrels are filled with an explosive powder called bluepowder. Each barrel has 5 Stamina and has 3 fire weakness. When destroyed, it begins sparking and smoldering. At the end of each turn while any barrels are smoldering, roll 1d6. On a roll of 3 or lower, the smoldering barrels explode, causing the following effect:

Exploding Barrel

Area — No action

2 burst — Each creature and object in the area

Effect: The target takes 20 damage and is pushed 2. A creature or object in the area of multiple exploding barrels is only affected once.

A creature can use a maneuver to throw a barrel a number of squares up to 5 plus the thrower's Might score. When thrown or force moved, a barrel takes damage equal to the number of squares moved.

Note that an explosion destroys balconies and other barrels, and note the effect of damage on the security door!

Elevator

The elevator can't be sabotaged, but its clear glass door can be broken (it has 1 Stamina). As soon as all creatures leave the elevator into the room, it descends into the depths of the facility, and its area becomes a 10-square deep elevator shaft.

Iron Security Door

The locked door is 2 squares wide and 2 squares high. It's ringed with red glowing tubes, and next to it are a lock and a speaker grille. Each square of the door has 20 Stamina.

A protagonist who knows the door's password can spend 3 intel to speak the password, causing it to open. This doesn't require an action.

A creature can also make a hard Pick the Lock agility test to pick the lock (see below).

If the door takes damage and is not destroyed, off-site guards are notified as if the party had achieved a tier 1 result on the Pick the Lock agility test.

Pick the Lock Agility Test:

- **≤11:** A speaker built into the door speaks: "This is Advance Control: a failed attempt has been registered on the security lock. Is everything OK?" A character can use a triggered action to make a followup test to dispel Advance Control's suspicions (see Talk with Advance Control below); failure to do so counts as a tier 1 result on the Talk with Advance Control test.
- **12-16:** The red lights around the door flicker to orange, then back to red. The door remains locked.
- **17+:** The red lights around the door turn green. The door is unlocked.

Talk with Advance Control Presence Test:

- **≤11:** "I'd better send a squad." The alarm level increases by 1. At the start of the next turn, a War Dog patrol enters through the elevator
- **12-16:** "Who is this?" Another character must use a triggered action to answer, making a followup Talk with Advance Control test; failure to do so counts as a tier 1 result on this test.
- **17+:** "Understood. Unlocking the door." The door lights turn green and it unlocks.

If the heroes open the security door while the battle rages on, quickly run the events in the Rescuing Lady Letitia section before continuing the battle. Lady Letitia is a follower who can help the heroes during this and future fights.

Tactics

The war dog subcommander and most of the war dog blackpackers charge the Condemned, while a few blackpackers retreat to guard the security door.

The war dog crucibites and war dog tormentites attack from a distance and throw barrels at the Condemned.

Once the war dogs are alerted, they move away from explosive barrels. One war dog operates Machine 2 to throw barrels or to move protagonists into Machines 1 and 3. The blackpackers make little effort to avoid blowing up barrels or allies (and note that their Loyalty Backpack affects allies as well as enemies). This encounter is a great chance for the Condemned to blow up some stuff up!

Ending the Encounter

The war dogs fight to the death. The heroes gain 1 Victory each.

Loot

he Condemned can take any surviving barrels. Each barrel is a size 1M object. A creature can carry a number of barrels equal to their Might.

Stat Blocks

MACHINE 1 **LEVEL 3 FORTIFICATION AMBUSHER**
EV 3

This machine includes several interlocking gears and is used for grinding powder.
Stamina: 20 **Size:** 2

p **Deactivate**
Machine 1 must be completely destroyed. When it is, the **Self Destruct** ability is activated.

? **Activate**
A creature or object moves adjacent to Machine 1.

Effect: the **Grinder** ability.

Grinder 2d10 + 2
Melee, Strike, Weapon Free triggered action
e Melee 1 x The triggering creature or object

Trigger: A creature or object moves adjacent to Machine 1.
≤11 7 damage
12–16 11 damage
17+ 15 damage
Effect: The target is pulled into the target's space and is then pushed 5 in the direction opposite to the one from which they came.

Self Destruct 2d10 + 2
Area Free triggered action
e Burst 2 x Each creature and object in the area

Trigger: Machine 1 is destroyed.
≤11 7 damage
12–16 11 damage
17+ 15 damage

t **Intel** A creature within 10 can spend 1 intel to know how the machine works.

MACHINE 2 **LEVEL 3 FORTIFICATION CONTROLLR**
EV 3

Machine 2 includes a seat and several large crystals, and is used for psionically lifting barrels.
Stamina: 20 **Size:** 2

p **Deactivate**
Machine 2 must be completely destroyed. When it is, the **Self Destruct** ability is activated.

Lifter
Ranged 10 Maneuver (Adjacent creature)
e Ranged 10 x One creature or object

Effect: The creature is vertical slid 5.

Self Destruct 2d10 + 2
Area Free triggered action
e Burst 3 x Each creature and object in the area

Trigger: Machine 2 is destroyed.
≤11 5 psychic damage
12–16 8 psychic damage
17+ 11 psychic damage

t **Intel** A creature within 10 can spend 1 intel to know how the machine works.

MACHINE 3 **LEVEL 3 FORTIFICATION AMBUSHER**
EV 3

Machine 3 bristles with lenses and probes, and is usually used for testing the grade of powder, but it's malfunctioning at the moment. A creature that enters a space adjacent to the machine takes 10 lightning damage and if M < 2 they are dazed (EoT).

Stamina: 20 **Size:** 2

p **Deactivate**
Machine 3 must be completely destroyed. When it is, the **Self Destruct** ability is activated.

? **Activate**
A creature or object moves adjacent to Machine 3.

Effect: the **Malfunction** ability.

Malfunction 2d10 + 2
Melee, Strike, Weapon Free triggered action
e Melee 1 x The triggering creature or object

Trigger: A creature or object moves adjacent to Machine 3.
≤11 6 lightning damage
12–16 10 lightning damage; M < 2 dazed (EoT)
17+ 14 lightning damage; M < 3 dazed (EoT)

Self Destruct 2d10 + 2
Area Free triggered action
e Burst 2 x Each creature and object in the area

Trigger: Machine 3 is destroyed.
≤11 5 lightning damage
12–16 7 lightning damage
17+ 10 lightning damage

t **Intel** A creature within 10 can spend 1 intel to know how the machine works.

WAR DOG BLACKPACKER **LEVEL 3 MINION CONTROLLER**
Humanoid, Soulless, War Dog

1M	5	7	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: — **With Captain:** +1 damage bonus to area abilities
M ight +1 A gility 0 R eason 0 I ntuition 0 P resence 0

r **Blackpowder Spray** 2d10 + 2 **Signature Ability**
Area, Weapon Main Action
R 2 cube within 5 x Each creature and object in the area
≤11: 2 damage; one blackpacker using the ability is reduced to 0 Stamina
12-16: 4 fire damage
17+: 5 fire damage

t **Loyalty Backpack**
When the blackpacker is reduced to 0 Stamina, their backpack explodes, dealing 2d6 fire damage to each creature and object in a 1 burst.

War dog crucibite

War dog tormentite

War dog subcommander

Rescuing Lady Letitia

- "As the security door hisses open, you see a bare prison cell. Inside is a young woman wearing laboratory whites."
- "She says, 'From the noise outside, I assume you're the rescue team?'"
- "She nods to you and grabs a pack hidden under her mattress. 'Lady Letitia. Codename ADVANCE. Let's go.'"

The young woman is the asset the Condemned have been sent to fetch. She is Lady Letitia de Toera, a young capital noble and a brilliant alchemist.

Lady Letitia is a capable fighter with deep knowledge of munitions (and a pack full of weapons hidden in her cell). She joins the party as a follower and participates in combat encounters. The party can decide who controls her character; the default choice is whoever opened the security door. Her preferred combat strategy is to throw a bluepowder grenade into a group of enemies; on the same turn, her mentor can deal damage to the grenade, causing it to explode.

Handout: Lady Letitia de Toera

LADY LETITIA DE TOERA **LEVEL 3 CONTROLLER RETAINER**
Humanoid, Human

1M	5	40	0	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight 0 A gility +2 R eason +3 I ntuition +1 P resence +1

r **Bluepowder Grenade** 2d10 + 2 **Signature Ability**
— Main Action
Effect: Lady Letitia throws a grenade into a space within 10 squares. The grenade is a 1T object. As a maneuver, another creature can pick up the grenade and throw it up to 10 squares. At the end of each Condemned character's turn, roll 1d6. On a 3 or lower, the grenade explodes in a 2 burst, dealing 10 fire damage to each creature in the area. The grenade has 1 Stamina and explodes early when reduced to 0 Stamina.

Level 4 Retainer Advancement Ability
r **Blackpowder Gun** **Encounter**
Ranged, Strike, Weapon Main Action
R Ranged 10 x One creature
≤11 7 damage; A < WEAK prone
12-16 11 damage; A < AVERAGE prone
17+ 16 damage; A < STRONG prone

Level 7 Retainer Advancement Ability
s **Overcharge** **Encounter**
Self Maneuver
Effect: Until the end of the turn, when Lady Letitia or their mentor makes a ranged strike that targets one creature, they can instead target that creature and each adjacent enemy.

Level 10 Retainer Advancement Ability
r **Blackpowder Bomb** **Encounter**
Area, Ranged, Weapon Main Action
R 5 cube within 10 x Each enemy in the area
≤11 8 damage; M < WEAK prone
12-16 12 damage; M < AVERAGE prone
17+ 16 damage; M < STRONG prone

Talking to Lady Letitia

Once Lady Letitia has been rescued, she'll answer any questions the Condemned have, although she'll remark that they don't have much time to chat.

- **Questioned About Herself:** "I'm the chief alchemist for House Vorona's advanced weapons research division. I was kidnapped and forced to work for Ajax making blackpowder."
- **Questioned About Blackpowder or the ADVANCE project:** "Ajax wants me to make blackpowder, but he's getting bluepowder. Same explosion, but I introduced a flaw: once it's lit, it takes a random amount of time to detonate. I've been slow walking a fix, hoping for a lucky break so I can blow up the whole project before he loses patience and executes me. And here you are, my lucky break."
- **Questioned about de Caserta:** "Damn that de Caserta. I thought rescue was impossible, so of course he had to do it. Where did he find you guys anyway? I don't think there's another team in Orden that could have pulled this off. If indeed we have pulled it off..."
- **Questioned about loyalty collars:** "I couldn't get them off, not without taking your head off too. De Caserta can probably do it; he knows everything about loyalty collars. Wait. Did he put those... ON you?"
- **Questioned about Khavettra:** "I don't know anything about what's going on in the Crysopolis. Haven't been off this floor."
- **Questioned about escape from the Crysopolis:** "I assume you have an escape plan, right?"

Reaching the Bluepowder Cache

After being rescued, Lady Letitia insists that the Condemned accompany her on one more important mission. "Listen, we don't have much time. I was forced to develop a bunch of explosive powder for Ajax. We need to destroy it before we leave."

If the Condemned argue, she says, "I'm not leaving that powder cache behind. I could use your help blowing it up, but if you want to run away without me, I won't stop you."

- If the Condemned help Lady Letetitia blow up the powder cache, continue to At the Bluepowder Cache Room.
- If the Condemned let Lady Letitia try to blow up the powder cache by herself, they are free to escape. Go to Combat: Sky Harbor Airfield. (Without the help of the Condemned, Lady Letitia is captured or killed in her attempt.)
- If the Condemned physically bar her from the bluepowder cache room, she protests: "Are you sure you want to leave everyone in the Armory alive to follow us?" If they insist, she accompanies them but they lose her services as a retainer. Go to Combat: Sky Harbor Airfield.

At the Bluepowder Cache Room

- "The metal door before you is covered with warning signs. 'No open flames beyond this point.' 'Drop lit powder in the synthesis pool.'"
- "A barrel by the door says 'No fire weapons beyond this point. Deposit fire weapons here.' Inside the barrel is a spear connected to a backpack by a long tube."

The backpack is an obliteration lance, a variant of the incineration lance (see Handout: Experimental Gear). Its Flamethrower ability's area is a 3 cube within 1 instead of a 2 cube within 1.

Sidebar: Content Warning: Body Horror

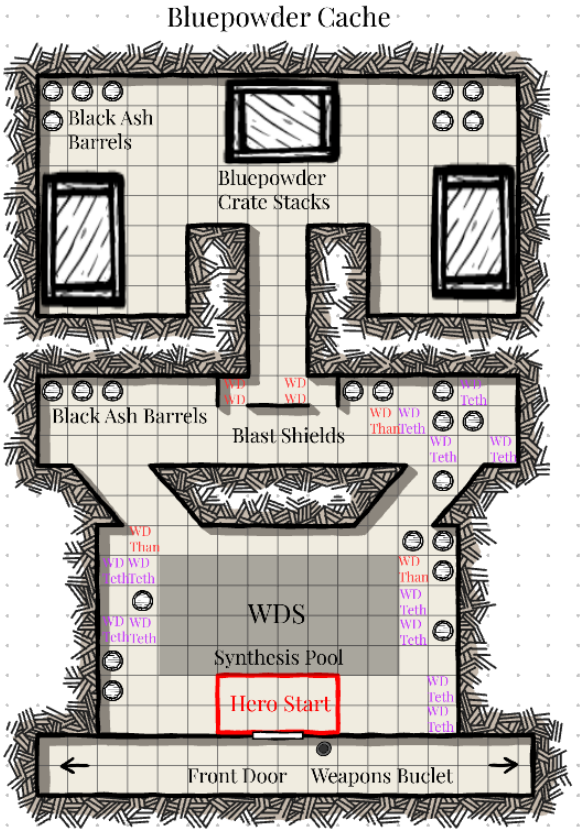
The descriptions of the war dog synthesite and devices include body horror, which can be a theme that makes some players uncomfortable. Feel free to change the description of the synthesite, describing it as a giant war dog.

Combat: Bluepowder Cache Room

- "In the middle of the room is a pool of liquid."
- "In the pool is a creature that looks like a pile of body parts, with tentacles of braided arms."
- "There are two passages in the opposite wall, surrounded by the same warning messages you've already seen."
- "Purple barrels are scattered around the room."

- "War dog guards stand at attention."

Use the Bluepowder Cache map to run this encounter. The room's ceilings are 4 squares high.



Bluffing By

The war dogs in the synthesis pool room haven't been fully briefed on the tactical situation. Attempts to bluff them are likely to be successful. If the Condemned successfully bluff, they can start in any space within 2 squares of the synthesis pool before someone shouts an alarm.

Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

Factory Floor Groups

Group	Creatures
1	**War dog synthesite**
2	**Two war dog war docs**
3	**War dog thanatite** (captain) **Four war dog tetherites** (minion squad)
4	**War dog thanatite** (captain) **Four war dog tetherites** (minion squad
5	**War dog thanatite** (captain) **Four war dog tetherites** (minion squad)

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add one **war dog thanatite and four war dog tetherites** to Groups 3 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove **group 5** at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove **groups 4 and 5** at the start of the encounter.

Synthesis Pool

The synthesis pool is filled with an opaque silver liquid capable of extinguishing the room's explosive powder (normal water can't do so). The pool is 1 square deep.

- A powder barrel or powder grenade dropped in the pool is destroyed.
- Creatures and objects in the liquid are immune to fire damage.

Blast Shields

The blast shields are floor-to-ceiling metal plates meant to protect the bluepowder storage room from careless uses of fire. Each square of the blast shield has 30 Stamina.

Bluepowder Crate Stacks

Each of the three bluepowder crate stacks are floor-to-ceiling stacks of dozens of crates of explosive bluepowder. Each crate stack has 5 Stamina and has 3 fire weakness. When destroyed, a crate stack begins smoldering, hissing, and spitting sparks. One minute later, it explodes with enough force to obliterate the entire Armory.

Black Ash Barrels

The barrels in this area are marked "BLACK ASH", which is an ingredient in Letitia's experimental bluepowder.

Each barrel has 5 Stamina and has 3 fire weakness. When destroyed, it explodes, causing the following effect:

Exploding Black Ash Barrel

Area — No action
2 burst — Each creature in the area
Effect: The target takes 5 damage. If the target is a creature, they teleport 3 squares in a random direction (roll 1d6: 1 north, 2 east, 3 south, 4 west, 5 up, 6 down). If they would teleport into or through an occupied square, they teleport as far as they can without doing so and take 5 additional damage.

A creature can use a maneuver to throw a barrel a number of squares up to 5 + the thrower's Might score. When thrown or force moved, a barrel takes damage equal to the number of squares moved.

Once lit, a barrel can only be quenched by throwing it in the synthesis pool.

A protagonist can ask Letitia to know how the barrels work.

Tactics

The war dog thanatites patrol the area, each with their war dog tetherites on leashes. In combat, the thanatites release the tetherites to attack and then use Snaking Entrails and Wall of Flesh to turn their tetherites into weapons and obstacles.

The war dog synthesite pulls enemies close, creates new minions each turn, and tries to quench explosions that would harm the war dogs.

The war dog war docs start the encounter near the blast shields. They advance to meet the Condemned, using their abilities to buff the soldiers in front of them.

Ending the Encounter

Lady Letitia doesn't leave the area until all three blue crates have been lit.

At the end of this encounter, the heroes gain 2 Victories each.

Loot

he Condemned can take any surviving barrels. Each barrel is a size 1M object. A creature can carry a number of barrels equal to their Might.

Stat Blocks

WAR DOG SYNTHESITE — **LEVEL 3 LEADER**
HUMANOID, SOULLESS, WAR DOG — EV 60

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
2	3	120	3	5

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight +3 A gility +2 R eason +1 I ntuition +2
P resence +2

r **Arm Tentacle** 2d10 + 3 **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon Main Action
e Melee 3 x Two creatures or objects
≤11 8 damage; pull 1
12–16 12 damage; pull 2; A < 2 grabbed
17+ 15 damage; pull 3; A < 3 grabbed
2 Malice: The synthesite increases the melee distance to 4 and the number of targets to 3.

r **Stitch in Time**
Area, Magic Maneuver
e 3 burst
Effect: Two **war dog tetherites** are created and extruded from the synthesite, appearing prone in adjacent spaces. They join a group of the synthesite's choice.
Special: Each time this ability is used, the number of war dog tetherites created increases by 1.

! **Quench Explosion**
— Triggered Action
e Ranged 3 x Self
Trigger: A size 1 or smaller creature or object is reduced to 0 Stamina and would explode.
Effect: The synthesite uses a tentacle to pull the triggering creature or object up to 5 squares. If it ends this movement in the synthesite pool, it doesn't explode.

t **End Effect:** At the end of each of their turns, the synthesite can take 5 damage to end one effect on them that can be ended by a saving throw. This damage can't be reduced in any way.

t **Loyalty Collars**
When the synthesite is rediced to 0 Stamina, the loyalty collars worn by their composite parts explode, dealing 2d6 damage to each enemy and object in a burst 2.

d **Incorporate Ally** **Villain Action 1**
Melee, Ranged, Strike
e Ranged 3 x One war dog minion
Effect: The synthesite pulls the target into its space. The war dog is reduced to 0 Stamina without their loyalty collar exploding. If the war dog is reduced to 0 Stamina, the synthesite regains 5 Stamina and their size increases to 3. A creature now in their space when they grow is pushed to the nearest unoccupied space and takes 5 damage.

r **Incorporate Allies** **Villain Action 2**
Melee, Ranged, Strike
e Ranged 3 x Two war dog minions
Effect: As Incorporate Ally but if both targets are reduced to 0 Stamina, the synthesite's size increases to 4.

r **Incorporate Horde** **Villain Action 3**
Melee, Ranged, Strike
e Ranged 3 x Each war dog minion in the area
Effect: As Incorporate Ally but if at least three targets are reduced to 0 Stamina, the synthesite's size increases to 5.

War dog tetherite

War dog thanatite

War dog war doc

Escaping the Armory

Once the bluepowder has been lit, the Condemned only have a minute to escape the armory before it blows.

If the Condemned are working with Khavettra, read the following:

- "Khavettra messages you via chatbox. 'From the alarms going off, it seems like you're in the Armory! It's right next to the Sky harbor. I'll find a safe route.'"
- "Following Khavettra's directions, you make it out of the armory without encountering guards."
- "Khavettra signals you over the talk box. 'I've cleared people out of the heavy cruiser. You can board it now.'"
- "Wait for me. Once I'm on board we'll take off."

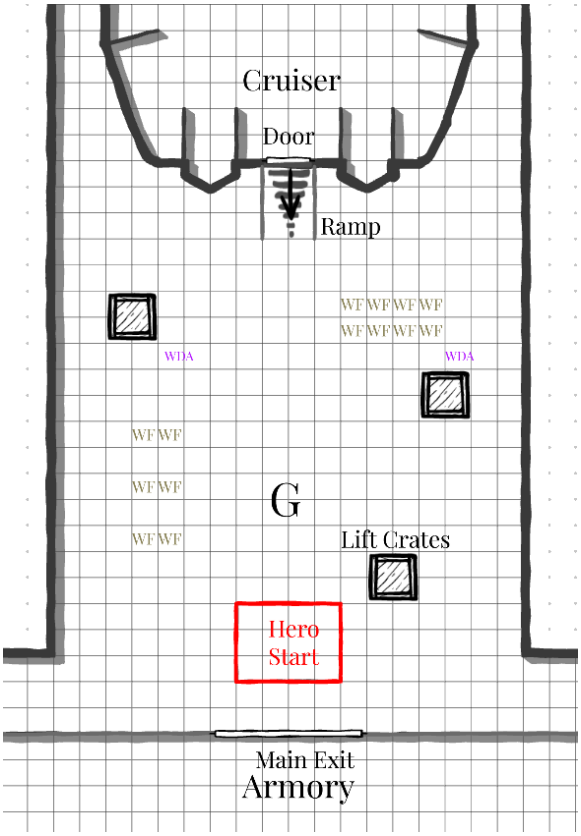
If the Condemned are not working with Khavettra, read the following:

- "As you leave the bluepowder room, you hear the pounding of running footsteps."
- "It sounds like multiple patrols are after you."

Combat: Sky Harbor Airfield

- "Ahead of you, the UNISOL heavy cruiser sits on a giant dock jutting out into the sky."
- "A ramp leads up into the cruiser. If you can get up that ramp, you might be able to escape on the ship."
- "Between you and the cruiser are a few hovering baggage vehicles and a platoon of war dogs, led by what looks like a big mechanical spider on frail legs."
- "The spider's head is a glass dome with a human head inside. It's Gerold's head."
- **If the Condemned have rescued Letitia:** "Letitia yells, 'Get to the cruiser!'"

Use the Sky Harbor map to run this encounter. This encounter takes place outside.



Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

Sky Harbor Airfield Groups

Group	Creatures
1	Spider Gerold
2	Two war dog arachnites
3	Six war dog war frogs
4	Eight war dog war frogs
5	Ten war dog war frogs (end of round one reinforcements)

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add one **war dog arachnite** to Group 2 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove one **war dog arachnite** from Group 2 at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove one **war dog arachnite** from Group 2 and remove **Group 4** at the start of the encounter.

Sidebar: Going Out With a Bang

If any of the Condemned are killed during this encounter, they have one last opportunity for a big hero moment (or a big jerk moment, depending on who's nearby them when they fall). When a Condemned is killed, their player can choose to detonate any blackpowder grenades and barrels in their possession, centering the explosions on the fallen character. It's up to the player whether this explosion was a redeeming act of self-sacrifice or a complete accident!

Dock

The dock extends over empty air, with the UNISOL heavy cruiser sitting at the end of it. The map shows only a section of the dock, which extends onward another several hundred feet. The dock has no railings; a creature that falls off the right or left side of the dock falls to their death unless they have a way to fly.

Heavy Cruiser

Only the rear portion of the UNISOL heavy cruiser is shown on the map. A ramp leads into the heavy cruiser. The ramp is not difficult terrain. A creature that climbs the ramp and enters the cruiser can use a maneuver to open or close the door.

Lift Crates

Three lift crates—flying crates filled with supplies—hover a foot above the dock. Each lift crate is 2 squares tall and has 30 Stamina. A lift crate can be pushed; it has a Stability of 0. If a lift crate is destroyed, it can no longer be moved.

A lift crate can be climbed. A prone creature on top of the lift crate has cover from creatures standing on the ground, but not vice versa.

Once per round, a creature on top of a lift crate can use their move action to cause the lift crate to move up to 5 squares. Once a lift crate has moved in this way, it can't move in this way again until the start of the next round.

When a lift crate enters a target creature or object's space, it can push that target up to four squares (minus Stability) without dealing or taking damage. If a target is not pushed, the lift crate doesn't enter the target's space and the lift crate's movement ends. The lift crate can push multiple targets on a turn but can't push the same target more than once on a turn.

A lift crate ignores difficult terrain and passes over prone creatures without affecting them. A creature with its own movement reduced can pilot it at full speed, but a frightened creature can't use it to move closer to the source of their fear.

Battle Events

Several timed events happen during this encounter.

Gerald's First Turn: Villain Monologue

The first time that Gerold takes a turn, before his turn he gives a momologue.

- "'Hey team! Good news! Ajax wasn't mad at me for being captured. He promoted me!'"
- "'My new mission is to stop you. Dead or alive.'"
- "'You see, you made a major mistake when you...'"

At this point, Gerold is so distracted by his monologue that one character has a chance to interrupt him with a free triggered action. The character can either hit him with a free strike (if within range) or shut him down with a clever reply.

If the character makes a clever reply, they make a Presence test. If the player comes up with an actual quip or one-liner, you can give them an edge or double edge on the test.

Clever Reply Presence Test:

- **≤11:** Gerold is taunted (EoT) by the character.
- **12-16:** Gerold is taunted (EoT) by the character and the party gains a Hero Token.
- **17+:** Gerold is taunted (save ends) by the character and the party gains a Hero Tokens.

After his monologue is shut down, Gerold says:

- "Ha ha, very funny, beat up on Gerold! You'll be laughing out of the other side of your mouth in a minute."
- "That armory is full of hundreds of war dog troops under my command."
- "War frogs! Attack!"

The armory's main exit opens, revealing an uncountable number of war dog war frogs in a huge hangar. Any damage the Condemned

deal to war dog war frogs in the hangar is irrelevant; if some are killed, there are always more of them.

End of Round 1: Reinforcements

At the end of round 1, a war dog officer inside the Armory yells, "Squad A, go!" Group 5 (ten war frogs) moves out of the armory. They either attack or, if they can't attack, turn their main action into a move.

End of Round 2: Explosive Situation

At the end of round 2, the Condemned get a chance to reap what they sow. The battle is significantly easier if they rescued Lady Letitia and followed her advice, igniting the bluepowder cache.

If the Condemned didn't ignite the bluepowder cache:

As in round 1, a war dog officer inside the Armory yells, "Squad B, go!" Ten war frogs move out of the armory, joining Group 5.

If the Condemned ignited the bluepowder cache:

At the end of round 2, a war dog officer inside the armory yells, "Squad B, go!" But just as more war frogs are about to join the fray, the bluepowder explodes. The entire Armory is blown to smithereens, and everyone inside it is killed.

Debris rains down onto the battlefield. Roll 1d6 for each creature or object within 10 squares of the Armory. On a roll of 3 or lower, the creature or object takes 15 damage. The area within 10 squares of the Armory becomes difficult terrain.

Additionally, roll 1d10 twice. For each roll, debris falls on the square with the corresponding number on the map (rerolling duplicates) and on the eight adjacent squares. Each creature in an affected square takes 15 damage, and those squares become difficult terrain.

If still alive, Gerold yells, "NOOOO!"

First Reaching the Cruiser: Khavettra's Message

Skip this section if the party is not working with Khavettra.

The first time a Condemned climbs the ramp and reaches the cruiser, Khavettra's talk box activates. Khavettra says, "I'm on my way! Don't leave without me!"

Once the last Condemned is on board the cruiser, the party has a choice. They can take off and abandon Khavettra, or they can keep the door open and wait for him, holding off the enemies until he arrives.

If the party waits, Khavettra arrives at the end of the round (or after the end of the enemy's next turn, whichever is later). He flies a one-person carpet to the cruiser's door, abandons the carpet, and runs inside. The party can now blast off!

If the party rescues Khavettra, they gain one Hero Token. If they fail to rescue him, they hear a shriek over Khavettra's talk box and then the talk box self destructs as Khavettra is killed.

Tactics

Gerold tries to stop the Condemned from boarding the cruiser by standing in their way and grabbing targets. He prioritizes Lady Letitia but doesn't grab the same target more than once.

The war dog arachnites stay at a distance, slowing creatures with their Web Vial and using Longarm Shrikegun to target the Condemned closes to the cruiser. They also climb on lift crates and use their move actions to control them.

The war dog war frogs attack the closest Condemned, using melee instead of ranged attacks. When possible they take cover behind lift crates. They climb lift crates only to reach enemies.

Enemies pursue the Condemned but don't enter the cruiser.

Stat Blocks

SPIDER GEROLD				LEVEL 4 LEADER
HUMANOID, SOULLESS, WAR DOG				EV 60
2	6	160	3	6
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight +4 A gility +2 R eason +2 I ntuition +2
P resence +2

r **Spiderblade** 2d10 + 3 **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon Main Action
e Melee 3 x One creature or object
≤11 10 damage
12–16 14 damage; A < 2 grabbed
17+ 17 damage; A < 3 grabbed
2 Malice: Spider Gerold targets a second creature or object.

r **Throw Bottle** 2d10 + 3
Melee, Strike, Weapon Main Action
r Ranged 10 x One creature or object
≤11 6 damage
12–16 8 damage; fire vulnerability 3 (EoT)
17+ 10 damage; fire vulnerability 5 (EoT)

! **Hair of the Dog**
— Triggered Action
e Ranged 10 x Self
Trigger: A creature within distance targets Spider Gerold with a power roll; Spider Gerold has at least 4 legs.
Effect: Spider Gerold takes a swig from a bottle. The power roll has a bane.
Spend 1 Malice: Spider Gerold uses Throw Bottle, targeting the triggering creature.

t **End Effect:** At the end of each of their turns, Spider Gerold can take 7 damage to end one effect on them that can be ended by a saving throw. This damage can't be reduced in any way.

t **Beta Version**
Spider Gerold has 8 legs. Whenever he takes at least 10 damage at once from a single ability, one of his legs malfunctions and is destroyed, and any creature grabbed by Spider Gerold is released. When Spider Gerold is reduced to 4 legs, he can no longer grab creatures with his Spiderblade. When Gerold is reduced to 3 legs, he falls prone and his speed is permanently reduced to 0.

d **Don't Let Them Get Away! Villain Action 1**
Ranged Maneuver
r Ranged 10 x Three creatures
Effect: Each target shifts up to their speed and can make a melee free strike. Spider Gerold can then reduce the target to 0 Stamina.

d **Spit Take** 2d10 + 3 **Villain Action 2**
Area
e 5 cube within 1 x Each creature and object in the area
≤11 7 fire damage
12–16 11 fire damage
17+ 14 fire damage

d **Now Our Debts Are Paid Villain Action 3**
Psionic, Ranged Maneuver
r Ranged 15 x One enemy
Effect: Spider Gerold vertical slides the target up to 3 squares, ignoring Stability. If the target was cruel or indifferent to Gerold's head, Gerold moves them away from their goal or into danger. If the target was generally kind to Gerold's head, Gerold moves them toward their destination or out of danger.

War dog arachnite

War dog war frog

Ending the Encounter

Once the party has boarded the cruiser, they can close the door and take off, leaving the Crysopolis behind.

If Gerold is still alive, he yells, "You haven't seen the last of me!" If he has more than 3 legs, several of them give out, causing him to fall prone. His legs wiggle in the air as he struggles to get up.

The heroes gain 2 Victories each.

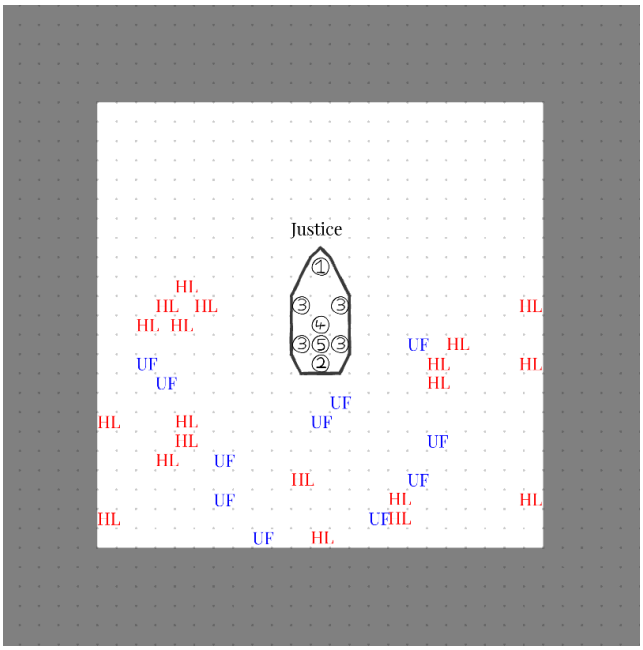
Montage Test: Flying the Cruiser

- "Out the window, you can see dozens of small fighter vessels and giant hawks lifting up from the sky harbor."
- "You hear the sound of cannons firing. The command bridge suddenly shakes as something slams into the cruiser. You're being fired upon."
- "The controls of the ship look straightforward, similar to the tiller of a sea ship."
- When the Condemned take the tiller, the cruiser blasts off into the cloudy skies.

The escape on the *Justice on Wings of Iron* is run as a simultaneous montage test and combat. The Condemned must use the *Justice on Wings of Iron*'s unfamiliar machinery while escaping or destroying enemy fighters.

Have a player track the *Justice on Wings of Iron*'s Stamina, which starts at 175 (the ship has a maximum Stamina of 200, but it was damaged by the cannons that fired at the ship.)

The cruiser is being pursued by fighter ships and Hawklords on hawkback, with more launching from the Crysopolis every minute. At the same time, the Condemned can move around the ship to operate its systems. Keep track of the position of the Condemned and the pursuing fighters using Handout: Flying the Justice on Wings of Iron.



Groups

The following enemy groups appear in this encounter.

Justice on Wings of Iron Groups

Group	Creatures
1	Ten UNISOL fighters (minion squad)
2	Ten hawklords (minion squad)
3	Ten hawklords (minion squad)

Encounter Adjustments

If this encounter has more or fewer than five heroes, make the following adjustments:

- For six heroes, add one **UNISOL fighter** to Group 1 and two **hawklords** to group 2 and 3 at the start of the encounter.
- For four heroes, remove one **UNISOL fighter** from Group 1 and two **hawklords** from group 2 and 3 at the start of the encounter.
- For three heroes, remove two **UNISOL fighters** from Group 1 and four **hawklords** from group 2 and 3 at the start of the encounter.

Enemy Squads

There are three squads of enemies present during this montage challenge: one group of UNISOL fighters (small, armed flying vessels) and two groups of hawklords riding giant hawks. Each squad takes a combat turn: one squad takes a turn after the first character's montage turn, the second squad takes a turn after the second character's montage turn, and so on. The enemies attack the *Justice on Wings of Iron*, not the Condemned. Unless otherwise noted, when new enemies appear during the encounter, they join an existing squad.

Enemy Signature Abilities

The *Justice on Wings of Iron* is a truly immense target. When a minion uses their signature ability against the ship, any number of squad members within range can add their free strike damage to the signature ability, ignoring the usual limit of three minions.

Tactical Movement

This is a running battle, with the *Justice* flying at full speed away from the Crysopolis and the enemies in pursuit at approximately the same speed. To represent this constant high-speed flight toward the top of the battle map, the combatants move using the following rules.

The Justice's position on the battlemap doesn't move. Whenever the Justice uses an effect that would change its movement, the enemies are instead repositioned.

The enemies are limited in their ability to move toward the top of the map (they're already flying at maximum speed in that direction). They can't use their move to move towards the top of the map (although some abilties and effects may allow them to do so).

An enemy that moves into the *Justice*'s space is destroyed.

Changes of elevation are not tracked.

Tactics

The UNISOL fighters move into attack range and hold their position. The hawklords use their maneuvers to move forward, trying to get adjacent to the *Justice*. Each squad uses a single signature ability, with the other members of the squad participating.

Montage: Action Stations!

The scale of this combat is different than that of a typical encounter. Squares are larger and turns are longer than normal (although they're not specifically defined). The Condemned can't use their normal abilities to affect enemies. To affect the battle, the Condemned must conduct a montage test, using the ship's action stations to destroy foes and evade the enemy pursuit. Each protagonist can attempt one montage challenge per round.

The ship has eight action stations, each numbered on the map: Communications, Engines, Medical, Repairs, and four Guns stations. To use an action station, a player moves their character to the appropriate numbered location. Unless otherwise noted, each action station can only be used once per turn. The same character can use the same action station on successive rounds.

This montage has no success or failure limit. Instead, the tactical situation changes based on the progress of the battle. The encounter ends when the *Justice on Wings of Iron* escapes or is destroyed. This montage is three rounds long, with events at the end of each round.

Spending Intel

The Condemned can make one last use of their hard-earned Intel, searching it for UNISOL codes. During the montage test, whenever a character makes a test, they can spend 1 intel to increase the tier result by 1, from a 1 to a 2 or a 2 to a 3.

Montage Challenges

The following challenges can be part of the montage test:

Station 1: Communications: The protagonist coordinates between different parts of the ship, synchronizing the party's activities. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Lead, Navigate, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* This challenge can be attempted once per round.

- **≤11:** Communications are scrambled. The next test made during this montage test has a double bane.
- **12–16:** The protagonist coordinates the team. Choose an action station other than communications. One protagonist currently in this action station can immediately take an additional montage challenge in addition to their normal turn this round. This doesn't count toward the action station's limit of one use per round.
- **17+:** The protagonist inspires the team. As tier 2, and the additional montage test gains an edge.

Station 2: Engines: The protagonist stokes the engines by shoveling fuel or by controlling the engine auto-fueler device. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Alchemy, Drive, Lift, Navigate, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* This challenge can be attempted once per round.

- **≤11:** The ship slows down. Move each enemy two squares toward the top of the map. Place one UNISOL fighter and two hawklords on the bottom row of the map.
- **12–16:** The ship speeds up. Move each enemy two squares toward the bottom of the map. Any enemy that moves off the map is removed from the combat.
- **17+:** The ship greatly speeds up. As tier 2, but move each enemy three squares toward the bottom of the map.

Station 3: Guns: The protagonist operates a cannon to target an enemy within 10 squares, using their test as a power roll. *Suggested Characteristics:* Agility, Intuition. *Suggested Skills:* Alertness, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* As with other damage sources, excess cannon damage can drop multiple minions.

- **≤11:** 5 damage, and the cannon explodes. Its operator takes 10 damage and this cannon action station can no longer be used.
- **12–16:** 10 damage.
- **17+:** 15 damage.

Station 4: Medical: When entering this station, the Condemned see medical equipment, powered saws, and loyalty collar components. A protagonist can use this station to remove their own loyalty collar or the loyalty collar of another protagonist. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Agility, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Blacksmithing, Escape Artist, Heal, Mechanics, Pick Lock, Sabotage, Timescape. *Special:* Any number of protagonists can occupy this station, and this challenge can be attempted every turn. It is automatically successful if the Condemned learned how to remove loyalty collars from the Archivist.

- **≤11:** The protagonist's loyalty collar explodes, killing them.
- **12–16:** The protagonist removes their loyalty collar and throws it away before it explodes. The *Justice* takes 10 damage.
- **17+:** The protagonist deactivates and removes their loyalty collar.

Station 5: Repairs: The protagonist runs around the ship, fixing broken machinery and extinguishing fires. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Lift, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* This challenge can be attempted once per round.

- **≤11:** The protagonist struggles to extinguish a fire. The *Justice* regains 5 Stamina. The protagonist takes 20 fire damage.
- **12–16:** The repairs are successful. The *Justice* regains 15 Stamina.
- **17+:** The repairs are very successful. The *Justice* regains 20 Stamina.

Other Actions: Instead of using an action station, the protagonist can use a main action or a maneuver. The protagonist has line of sight only to creatures in the same action station. *Suggested activities:* heal an ally, assist a test.

End of Round 1: Cloud Cover

- "The cruiser flies into the clouds. Visibility drops, for both you and your enemies."

The shaded area on the map is obscured by clouds. Any enemy that starts its turn in or enters the clouds is removed from the encounter.

End of Round 2: Out of the Clouds

- "The cruiser bursts out of the clouds. The sea is visible below you."
- "Around you, fighters burst from the clouds after you… more than you thought."

The shared area on the map is no longer obscured. Enemies that start their turn or end in the shaded area are no longer removed from the encounter.

Place 10 UNISOL fighters in the shaded area. This is a new group. You can place each enemy anywhere in the shaded area as long as it isn't adjacent to another enemy.

Once you have placed the new enemies and given the players a moment to think about the changed odds, read or paraphrase the following:

- "While all this is going on: let's cut over to House Vorona's flagship, the *Capital Sea Ship Broad Sword*."
- "Right now, Ottavio de Caserta is standing on its heavily armed deck, his telescope trained toward the Crysopolis."
- "The *Justice on Wings of Iron* bursts from the clouds. De Caserta laughs. 'The crazy bastards stole a UNISOL cruiser!"
- He spots the swarms of fighters and hawklords. "And they've got the hounds of hell behind them." He nods to the officer next to him. "Captain, my team appears to have succeeded brilliantly! I think they earned a hero's welcome, don't you?"
- "Gunners! Target those fighters! Rip them apart!"

If the Condemned haven't rescued Lady Letitia, read or paraphrase the following:

- "You spot Ottavio de Caserta on the other ship's deck. Now would be a great time to have those loyalty collars off before he gets his hands on you."

During the final round of this challenge, the Condemned can take the same challenges as before with the following changes:

- In addition to taking their normal challenge, have each player control one of the cannons on the *HMS Broad Sword*. The player can take a bonus Guns challenge with a power roll of 2d10+3 and no range limit.

End of Round 3: Victory

- "The *Justice on Wings of Iron* comes within close range of the *CSS Broad Sword*. The *Broad Sword*'s cannons fire at point blank range, completely obliterating all remaining enemy fighters."
- "From the *Broad Sword*, De Caserta yells, 'Good hunting, team. Come aboard with Lady Letitia and let's get those collars off you.'"

If the *Justice* is Destroyed

If the Justice is reduced to 0 Stamina, the Condemned have time to race to the single escape pod—which can only hold two passengers. The party can make a Power Grab (see the Introduction) to determine who gets inside, with the winner choosing the first occupant and the runner-up choosing the second.

While those who remain on the *Justice* die horribly, the escape pod is picked up by Ottavio de Caserta in his flagship the *Broadsword*.

- If neither of the occupants of the escape pod is Lady Letitia, de Caserta is not pleased. He detonates the loyalty collar of any protagonist still wearing one. A protagonist who has removed their collar manages to flee, but there's a sizeable bounty on their head.
- If Lady Letitia is one of the occupants of the escape pod, Capital is saved! De Caserta rewards the second occupant of the escape pod with a pardon. "It's too bad about the loss of the *Justice*. And your comrades too, of course."

With the destruction of the *Justice*, the adventure ends.

Stat Blocks

HAWKLORD	**LEVEL 3 MINION HARRIER**			
Vehicle	EV 4 for four minions			
1M	4	5	0	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight +0 A gility +2 R eason 0 I ntuition 0 P resence 0

r **Iron Ball** 2d10 + 2 **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon Main Action
e Melee 1 x One creature or object per minion
≤11: 3 damage; one hawklord collides with the cruiser and is destroyed
12-16: 6 damage
17+: 9 damage; an iron ball damages part of the cruiser. Choose a type of action station by rolling 1d6 (a roll of 6 has no effect). Until the end of the encounter, characters take a bane while making tests in this type of action station. Further damage to the same type of action station has no effect.

t **Speedy Wings** Once per turn, the hawklord can use two squares of its movement to move in the direction of the top of the map.

UNISOL FIGHTER	**LEVEL 4 MINION BRUTE**			
Vehicle	EV 6 for four minions			
1M	2	10	0	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight +2 A gility 0 R eason 0 I ntuition 0 P resence 0

r **Hard Light Cannon** 2d10 + 2 **Signature Ability**
Ranged, Strike, Weapon Main Action
R Ranged 10 x One creature or object
≤11: 4 damage; one UNISOL fighter temporarily loses power and moves five squares toward the bottom of the map (remove it if it leaves the map)
12-16: 8 damage
17+: 12 damage; the UNISOL fighters use their auxiliary energy. Move each UNISOL fighter one square toward the top of the map

Choice of Endings

Even if the *Justice* escapes its pursuers, the party's fate is far from certain. Depending on the actions of the Condemned througout the adventure, the party can earn one of several possible endings.

If the Condemned haven't rescued Lady Letitia and they are all wearing loyalty collars, they earn Ending 1, You Have Failed Me.

If the Condemned haven't rescued Lady Letitia and at least one has freed themselves from their loyalty collars, they earn Ending 2, Double Cross.

If the Condemned have rescued Lady Letitia and at least some are wearing loyalty collars, they earn Ending 3, Capital Agents.

If the Condemned have rescued Lady Letitia and have all freed themselves from their loyalty collars, they have choices. Read the following:

- "With your loyalty collars off, de Caserta has no hold on you."
- "Do you want to go aboard the *Broadsword* and bring Lady Letitia to de Caserta?" If the players choose this, they earn Ending 3, Capital Agents.
- "Or do you want to send Lady Letitia to de Caserta, outfly the *HMS Broadsword*'s cannons, and escape with the *Justice*?" If the players choose this, they earn Ending 4, Freedom of the Skies.

Ending 1: You Have Failed Me

- "De Caserta boards the *Justice on Wings of Iron*. He gingerly steps over the headless corpses of the Condemned."
- "They came back without the asset," he muses. "I suppose they thought I was bluffing about the loyalty collars."
- "De Caserta motions to his aide. 'Get a message to the warden of the Cauldron. Looks like we need five more volunteers.'" (If there were more or less than five Condemned characters, replace the number with the actual number of characters.)

The Condemned have failed the mission and paid the price! If there's one consolation, it's that de Caserta didn't get what he wanted either.

Ending 2: Double Cross

- "De Caserta stares up at the *Justice on Wings of Iron* hovering in the air above him. 'Splendid work, agents! You've earned your freedom and more. Come on down and hand over the asset.'"
- "Above him, a hatch opens on the heavy cruiser. There's a long pause. De Caserta frowns."
- "Something flies out of the hatch and lands on deck. It's a bundle of deactivated loyalty collar parts."
- "The heavy cruiser's engines activate, and the *Justice on Wings of Iron* blasts away."
- "De Caserta examines the loyalty collars and angrily throws them down onto the deck. 'Dammit! There goes the world's best hope.'"

The heroes (or at least those heroes who managed to remove their collars) escape without giving de Caserta what he wanted. Without that asset, the future looks bleak for Capital... but that's someone else's problem. With a stolen heavy cruiser, who knows what mischief the Condemned can cause.

Ending 3: Capital Agents

- "You take Lady Letitia aboard the *HMS Broadsword*."
- "Lady Letitia and de Caserta hug. Lady Letitia says, 'You did it again, Ottavio. Your agents were amazing.'"
- "De Caserta gestures, and technicians step forward to remove your collars. 'You all have full pardons, as I promised.'"
- "'I'll land you anywhere you want. But consider this offer: you'd make great Capital agents, if you ever want to use your abilities for good.'"
- "'Well maybe not for *good*. House Vorona is rich and grateful. How about...for *profit*.'"

Give each character a chance to decide their future. Each is free to join up with Caserta (becoming valued agents) or leave with their pardons, returning to their old lives or starting new ones.

Ending 4: Freedom of the Skies

- "An escape pod launches from the *Justice on Wings of Iron*. It lands on the deck of the *Broadsword*. Lady Letitia [and Khavettra, if present] climb out."
- "'They say no thanks,' says Lady Letitia. 'You can keep your pardons and they'll keep the heavy cruiser. They also sent you this.' Lady Letitia holds up a handful of unlocked loyalty collars."
- De Caserta frowns as the *Justice on Wings of Iron* turns around and blasts away, too fast for the *HMS Broadsword* to fire on it. Then he starts to laugh. 'I underestimated them again,' he says. 'Well, they might have just saved the world. Let them play pirate if they want. They deserve it.'"

Continuing the Campaign

"*My friends! I have another job for you. Ajax's wizard has identified a second Sky Elf city he believes he can raise—bigger than the Crysopolis.*

"This must not be allowed. The mission is yours if you want it."

"You want us to blow it up."

"No.

"I want you to steal *it!"*

If the players earned ending 3 or 4 and wish to continue the adventures of the Condemned, they earned enough XP during this adventure to reach level 4.

> Sidebar: Stealing the Justice
>
> If the Condemned stole the *Justice on Wings of Iron*, they can use it as an aerial home base. Although they don't currently have sufficient fuel to take it into the Timescape or use the ship's montage challenges, they can use it as a flying vehicle with a speed of 10 and 200 Stamina. While the Condemned can no longer use its cannons, they can conduct combat normally from its open deck.

Even if the Condemned escaped de Caserta at the end of the adventure, as Capital's spymaster he knows how to get them a message. If a sufficiently world-shaking crisis arises, he'll call on them again: this time not as prisoners but as trusted agents.

Handout: Creating a Condemned

This adventure is for level 3 characters. Players can either create a new character or use one of the provided pregenerated characters.

If a player is creating a new character, they should follow these steps:

1. Determine Backstory

Each character starts as an inmate in the Cauldron, Capital's prison.

Players should consider the following questions about their character:

What special precautions are in place to keep the character from escaping their cell? If a player isn't sure, you can offer some suggestions: an antimagic field? Guards with earplugs to protect against magic or intense personal charm? Electrified or reinforced bars?

Prisoners are allowed to pursue a hobby or skill as long as they don't misbehave. **What is the character doing when the guards arrive?** Working out? Playing an instrument? Building a model? Or maybe you've never been cooperative enough to get a reward?

What is the character in for? Did they torch a tavern? Kill a hero? Pull off a heist?

How did they plead? Was the character set up? Did they take the fall to protect someone? Or are they as bad as everyone says, or even worse?

Note: The pregenerated characters in this adventure provide answers to some of these questions. As with any other aspect of these characters, these answers are just suggestions. Your players should feel free to rephrase, rewrite, or replace their characters' pregenerated backstories!

2. Choose a Complication

Villains tend to have outsized pasts. In a group of antiheroes, you can't throw a rock without hitting someone who made a deal with a fell entity, fell in a vat of acid, or otherwise had a brush with the sinister.

Although it's not required, each player can choose a complication (see Complications in *Draw Steel: Heroes*). They can also work with you to create a new complication, use one of the complications belonging to a pregenerated character, or use the complication below.

Sight of Blood

You like to dish out pain, not take it.

While you are bleeding or winded, your abilities that cost a heroic resource cost one less of that heroic resource (minimum 1) if they deal damage, and they cost one more heroic resource if they don't deal damage.

3. Create a Title

Many villains and antiheroes are driven by their ambitions and passions. They are motivated by a desire so strong—for power, revenge, carnage, riches, or another goal—that they are willing to go to any end to fulfill it.

Each player can choose a 1st echelon title (see Titles in *Draw Steel: Heroes*), one that speaks to their past adventures or their motivating desires. A player can also work with you to create a new title, use a title belonging to one of the pregenerated characters, or use the title below.

Everything Looks Like a Nail

"I've spent a lot of time honing this skill. Shame for all that effort to go to waste."

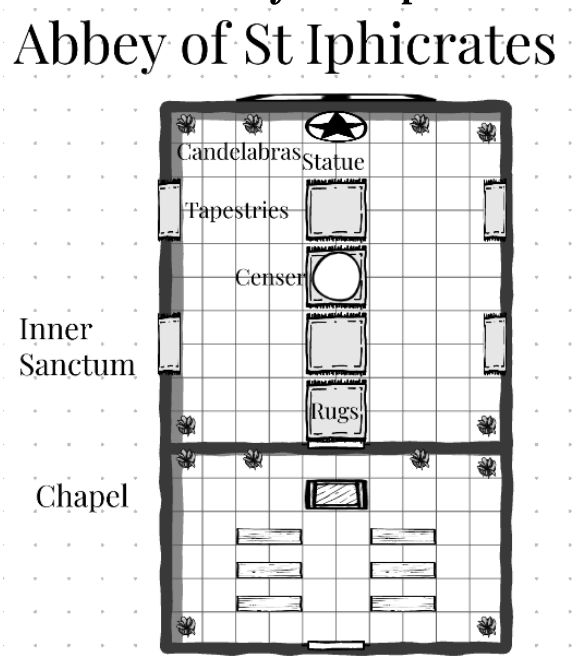
Prerequisite: Your compulsion to use a particular skill has gotten you into trouble.

Effect: Choose a skill when you gain this title. The first time each game session that you make a test using this skill, you gain a Hero Token. Additionally, you gain an edge whenever you make a test using this skill.

4. Choose a Downtime Ability

As a level 3 character, each Condemned has already survived several escapades before the start of this adventure (including the one that landed them in jail). To represent this history, give the character a benefit from the Learn from a Master downtime ability (see Downtime Projects in *Draw Steel: Heroes*), gaining the Acquire Ability, Improve Ability, or Improve Control benefit.

Handout: Abbey of St Iphicrates



Mission: Extract enemy spy, dead or alive (preferably alive). Minimize civilian casualties.

Target: "Gerold", real name unknown. A spy for Lord Ajax. Has been observed entering and leaving the Abbey of St Iphicrates.

Abbey of St Iphicrates: Location: Corner of Cartwright Street and Long Alley. Inhabitants: Abbot de Montese, Brother Aglio, Sister Aria. The **chapel** is open for public worship. The **inner sanctum** is for abbey inhabitants only.

Teleporter: The abbey contains a teleportation device that allows Gerold to leave the city. He must be apprehended before he can use the teleporter.

Handout: Experimental Gear

Ashen Armor

Made of spiked bone plates, this armor steals the souls of your victims.

Keywords: Heavy Armor, Magic

1st Level: While you wear this armor, you gain a +6 bonus to Stamina. When you reduce a creature to 0 Stamina with a strike, you gain a surge.

5th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +12. When you reduce a creature to 0 Stamina with a strike, you can spend a Recovery.

9th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +21. When you reduce a creature to 0 Stamina with a strike, you gain temporary Stamina equal to the creature's maximum Stamina or your Recovery Value, whichever is less.

Blackpowder Grenade

These grenades made from an advanced explosive are highly restricted; this is the first time you've ever (legally) owned one.

Keywords: Hands, Magic

Effect: As a main action, you can throw the grenade. Use the following ability.

> Blackpowder Grenade
>
> *Count to three, then throw..*
>
> Area, Magic — Main action
>
> e 3 cube within 5 — Each creature and object in the area
>
> Power Roll + Might, Agility, or Reason
>
> **≤11** 5 + M, A, or R damage
>
> **12-16** 8 + M, A, or R damage
>
> **17+** 11 + M, A, or R damage

Besides the standard model, several specialized varieties of blackpowder grenade are available:

Ignition Grenade: This grenade is inaudible and deals fire damage.

Stun Grenade: This grenade deals sonic damage. A creature that would be killed by the grenade's damage is instead knocked unconscious for 1 hour.

Remote Grenade: The grenade doesn't explode until 1 minute has passed or you use a maneuver to detonate it remotely.

Shaped Grenade: The grenade deals 15 damage but only to creatures and objects in its square.

Blackpowder Launcher

This bulky arm-mounted tube fires powerful blackpowder rockets.

Keywords: Hands, Magic

Effect: You can use the ability below. Once you have done so, you can't do so again until you use a main action to reload the blackpowder launcher. Using the blackpowder launcher doesn't expend a Blackpowder Grenade.

> Blackpowder Rocket
>
> *A thunk, a brief whistling sound, and then utter destruction.*
>
> Area, Magic — Main action
>
> e 3 cube within 10 — Each creature and object in the area
>
> Power Roll + Might, Agility, or Reason
>
> **≤11** 5 + M, A, or R damage; slide 1
>
> **12-16** 8 + M, A, or R damage; slide 1
>
> **17+** 11 + M, A, or R damage; slide 1

Incineration Lance

Liquid fire jets from nozzles along this spear's haft.

Keywords: Magic, Polearm

1st Level: Any weapon ability that deals rolled damage using this weapon deals an extra 1 fire damage. Additionally, you gain the following action.

> Flame Thrower
>
> *Flame gouts from the lance, cooking everyone nearby.*
>
> Area, Magic — Main action
>
> e 2 cube within 1 — Each creature and object in the area
>
> Power Roll + Agility or Might
>
> **≤11** 4 + M or A damage
>
> **12-16** 6 + M or A damage
>
> **17+** 9 + M or A damage
>
> **Effect:** If you used this ability since the start of your last turn, the lance overheats and your space is included in the area.

5th Level: The weapon's extra fire damage increases to 2, and this extra fire damage is applied to the weapon's Flame Thrower ability.

9th Level: The weapon's extra fire damage increases to 3, and this extra fire damage is applied to the weapon's Flame Thrower ability.

Infiltration Suit

This slick leather armor covers you completely except for your face.

Keywords: Light Armor, Magic

1st Level: While you wear this armor, you gain a +6 bonus to Stamina, and you can use a maneuver to give your face the illusory appearance of any bipedal creature of equivalent size that you have previously seen. Your body, clothing, and gear are unchanged.

5th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +12. Additionally, when you use this armor to transform your face, your voice is transformed as well.

9th Level: The armor's bonus to Stamina increases to +21. Additionally, you can use a main action to become invisible until the start of your next turn.

Power Glove

When you strain your psi-augmented muscles, this metal-veined glove hums with the sound of your sizzling neurons.

Keywords: Hands, Psychic

Effect: While you wear this glove, your Might score is equal to the highest of your Reason, Intuition, or Presence scores if it is lower than that score.

The Silencer

This articulated metal whip coils and uncoils at your mind's command.

Keywords: Psionic, Whip

1st Level: Any weapon ability that deals rolled damage using this weapon deals an extra 1 psychic damage. Additionally, you gain a +1 bonus to the distance of the Grab maneuver and a grabbed creature can't speak.

5th Level: The weapon's extra psychic damage increases to 2, and a creature grabbed by you can't breathe.

9th Level: The weapon's extra psychic damage increases to 3, and you gain a +1 bonus to the distance of your melee weapon abilities made with the whip.

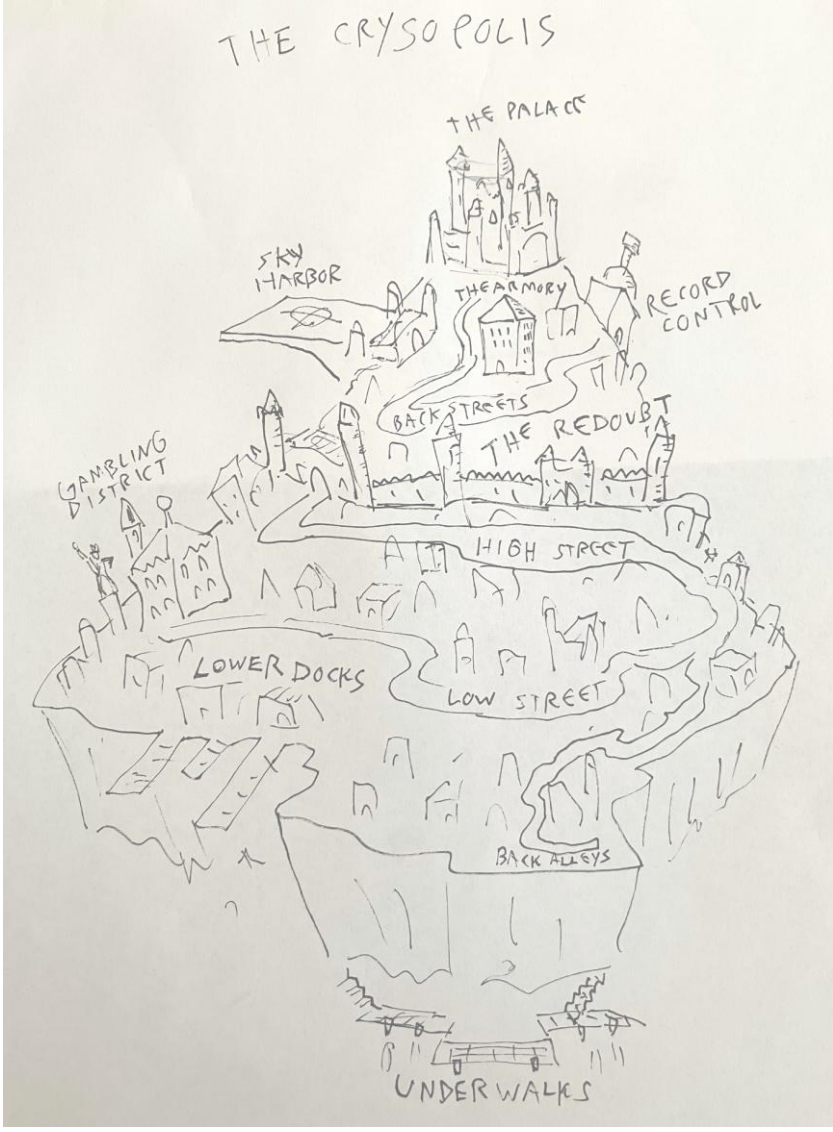
Targeting Lens

This red lens covers a single eye. Its crimson glow can be seen only by the creatures you have marked for death.

Keywords: Head, Psychic

Effect: While you wear this lens, you can use a maneuver to target a creature you can see. Until you target a different creature, you always know the creature's distance and direction, you and the creature can't be concealed from each other, and while the creature is winded you know their remaining Stamina total. When you deal damage to the creature with an ability, the creature takes extra damage equal to your highest characteristic.

Handout: The Crysopolis

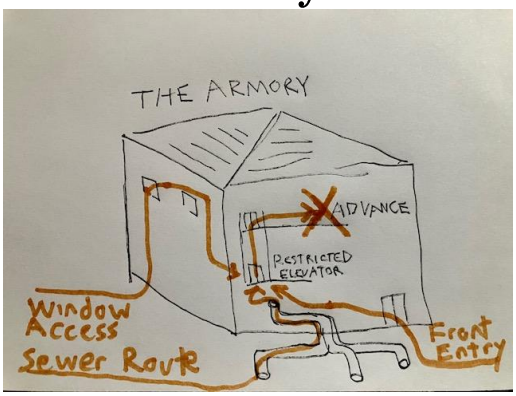


Intel Tracker _____

- **Costs 1 intel: Reroll.** When a character makes a test and doesn't like the outcome, they can reroll. They must use the new roll.

Alarm Level Tracker _____

Handout: Armory Sketch



Handout: Lady Letitia de Toera

LADY LETITIA DE TOERA **LEVEL 3 CONTROLLER RETAINER**
Humanoid, Human

1M	5	40	0	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** —
Movement: —
M ight 0 A gility +2 R eason +3 I ntuition +1 P resence +1

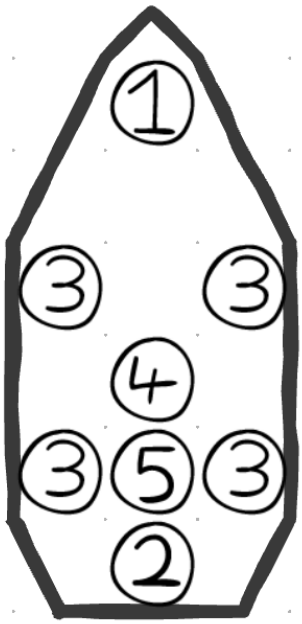
r **Bluepowder Grenade** 2d10 + 2 **Signature Ability**
— Main Action
Effect: Lady Letitia throws a grenade into a space within 10 squares. The grenade is a 1T object. As a maneuver, another creature can pick up the grenade and throw it up to 10 squares. At the end of each Condemned character's turn, roll 1d6. On a 3 or lower, the grenade explodes in a 2 burst, dealing 10 fire damage to each creature in the area. The grenade has 1 Stamina and explodes early when reduced to 0 Stamina.

Level 4 Retainer Advancement Ability
r **Blackpowder Gun** **Encounter**
Ranged, Strike, Weapon Main Action
R Ranged 10 x One creature
≤11 7 damage; A < WEAK prone
12-16 11 damage; A < AVERAGE prone
17+ 16 damage; A < STRONG prone

Level 7 Retainer Advancement Ability
s **Overcharge** **Encounter**
Self Maneuver
Effect: Until the end of the turn, when Lady Letitia or their mentor makes a ranged strike that targets one creature, they can instead target that creature and each adjacent enemy.

Level 10 Retainer Advancement Ability
r **Blackpowder Bomb** **Encounter**
Area, Ranged, Weapon Main Action
R 5 cube within 10 x Each enemy in the area
≤11 8 damage; M < WEAK prone
12-16 12 damage; M < AVERAGE prone
17+ 16 damage; M < STRONG prone

Handout: Flying the *Justice on Wings of Iron*



The ship has eight action stations, each numbered on the map. To use an action station, a player moves their character to the appropriate numbered location. Unless otherwise noted, only one character can occupy each space at a time.

Action Stations

1: Communications

2: Engines

3: Guns (four guns stations are available)

4: Medical (any number of characters can enter)

5: Repairs

Spending Intel

The Condemned can make one last use of their hard-earned Intel. During the montage test, whenever a character makes a test, they can spend 1 intel to increase the tier result by 1, from a 1 to a 2 or a 2 to a 3.

Montage Challenges

The following challenges can be part of the montage test:

Station 1: Communications: The protagonist coordinates between different parts of the ship, synchronizing the party's activities. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Lead, Navigate, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* This challenge can be attempted once per round.

- **≤11:** Communications are scrambled. The next test made during this montage test has a double bane.
- **12-16:** The protagonist coordinates the team. Choose an action station other than communications. One protagonist currently in this action station can immediately take an additional montage challenge in addition to their normal turn this round. This doesn't count toward the action station's limit of one use per round.
- **17+:** The protagonist inspires the team. As tier 2, and the additional montage test gains an edge.

Station 2: Engines: The protagonist stokes the engines by shoveling fuel or by controlling the engine auto-fueler device. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Alchemy, Drive, Lift, Navigate, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* This challenge can be attempted once per round.

- **≤11:** The ship slows down. Move each enemy two squares toward the top of the map. Place one UNISOL fighter and two hawklords on the bottom row of the map.
- **12-16:** The ship speeds up. Move each enemy two squares toward the bottom of the map. Any enemy that moves off the map is removed from the combat.
- **17+:** The ship greatly speeds up. As tier 2, but move each enemy three squares toward the bottom of the map.

Station 3: Guns: The protagonist operates a cannon to target an enemy within 10 squares, using their test as a power roll. *Suggested Characteristics:* Agility, Intuition. *Suggested Skills:* Alertness, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* As with other damage sources, excess cannon damage can drop multiple minions.

- **≤11:** 5 damage, and the cannon explodes. Its operator takes 10 damage and this cannon action station can no longer be used.
- **12-16:** 10 damage.
- **17+:** 15 damage.

Station 4: Medical: When entering this station, the Condemned see medical equipment, powered saws, and loyalty collar components. A protagonist can use this station to remove their own loyalty collar or the loyalty collar of another protagonist. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Agility, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Blacksmithing, Escape Artist, Heal, Mechanics, Pick Lock, Sabotage, Timescape. *Special:* Any number of protagonists can occupy this station, and this challenge can be attempted every turn. It is automatically successful if the Condemned learned how to remove loyalty collars from the Archivist.

- **≤11:** The protagonist's loyalty collar explodes, killing them.
- **12-16:** The protagonist removes their loyalty collar and throws it away before it explodes. The *Justice* takes 10 damage.
- **17+:** The protagonist deactivates and removes their loyalty collar.

Station 5: Repairs: The protagonist runs around the ship, fixing broken machinery and extinguishing fires. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Lift, Mechanics, Timescape. *Special:* This challenge can be attempted once per round.

- **≤11:** The protagonist struggles to extinguish a fire. The *Justice* regains 5 Stamina. The protagonist takes 20 fire damage.
- **12-16:** The repairs are successful. The *Justice* regains 15 Stamina.
- **17+:** The repairs are very successful. The *Justice* regains 20 Stamina.

Other Actions: Instead of using an action station, the protagonist can use a main action or a maneuver. The protagonist has line of sight only to creatures in the same action station. *Suggested activities:* heal an ally, assist a test.

Director Reference: Crysopolis Infiltration Montage Test

To move around restricted areas in Crysopolis (for instance, to exit the War Dog Teleportation Hub room), the Condemned must make a **Crysopolis Infiltration montage test**. This is a special, repeated montage test that the Condemned may face when they enter or leave a restricted location in Crysopolis. This adventure will tell you whenever the story requires a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test.

This montage test is one round long, or two rounds if the party consists of three or fewer characters.

If the montage test is one round long, the party achieves total success if they hit the success limit, achieve partial success if time runs out with at least one success, and fail if they hit the failure limit.

Crysopolis Infiltration Test Difficulty

Heroes	Success Limit	Failure Limit
Three	3	3
Four	2	2
Five	3	2
Six	3	3

Montage Challenges

The following challenges can be part of the montage test:

Avoid Traffic: By sticking to the least-traveled areas, the Condemned avoid notice. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Navigate, Search, Track.

Case Out (not available while leaving an objective): The Condemned learn guard schedules and acquire blueprints. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Reason. *Suggested Skills:* Alertness, Architecture, Eavesdrop, Navigate, Pick Pocket.

Demolition (not available while entering an objective): The Condemned blast their way out. This activity doesn't require a test; it automatically succeeds, but it raises the alarm level by 1 and the character must spend a blackpowder grenade.

Go Off Script (not available while leaving an objective): Instead of helping with the mission, the character indulges in some petty act of villainy or mayhem. This activity counts as a failure. The party gains a Hero Token. *Special:* This challenge can be taken any number of times.

Lie Low (not available while entering an objective): The Condemned find a place to hide for a bit. *Suggested Characteristics:* Agility. *Suggested Skills:* Hide, Sneak.

Make a Diversion: After causing a ruckus, the Condemned quickly go the other way. *Suggested Characteristics:* Might, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Alchemy, Lift, Perform, Sabotage.

Make Criminal Contacts (not available while leaving an objective): The Condemned find shady people who lead them by hidden ways. *Suggested Characteristic:* Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Criminal Underworld, Rumors.

Perform Magic: A character uses magic to teleport the party, melt a wall, turn invisible, gather information, or perform a similar magical feat, provided the Narrator judges that it would be helpful to do so. The character must spend any resources necessary to use the ability. This activity doesn't require a test.

Pose as Guards: Using stolen uniforms lets the Condemned move freely through the city. The test for this challenge gains an edge if the characters defeated war dog guards during their infiltration. *Suggested Characteristics:* Intuition, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Disguise, Lie, Search.

Question Gerold: The protagonists threaten or sweet-talk Gerold into choosing the best route. *Suggested Characteristic:* Might, Presence. *Suggested Skills:* Empathize, Flirt, Interrogate, Intimidate, Persuade. *Special:* This activity automatically succeeds if the protagonist gives Gerold a bottle of Riojan Gold or another good wine.

Skulk in the Shadows: The Condemned keep out of sight. *Suggested Characteristic:* Agility. Suggested Skills: Hide, Sneak. *Special:* The heroes can attempt this challenge twice during the montage test.

Take Out a Sentry: The Condemned assassinate a sentry in their way, opening a path. *Suggested Characteristic:* Might, Agility. *Suggested Skills:* Gymnastics, Hide, Jump, Sneak.

Montage Test Outcomes:

One of the following outcomes ends the montage test:

Total Success: The heroes reach their goal.

Partial Success: The heroes reach their goal, but the alarm level of the Crysopolis goes up by 1.

Total Failure: The heroes reach their goal, but the alarm level of the Crysopolis goes up by 2. Additionally, they encounter a patrol.

- If the alarm level is 2, the Condemned immediately fight a War Dog Squad (see below).
- If the alarm level is 3, the Condemned immediately fight a War Dog Patrol (see below).
- If the alarm level is 4 or higher, the Condemned immediately fight a War Dog Strike Team (see below).

If the Condemned want to avoid combat, they can spend a number of intel equal to the current alarm level to give an appropriate password. Otherwise, they must fight the patrol.

Montage Test Combat Encounters:

Failures during a Crysopolis Infiltration montage test can lead to combats with a war dog squad, patrol, or strike team. These encounter groups are presented below. Each combat takes place on your choice of the Crysopolis Road map or the War Dog Facility map (see below), and they don't provide Victories.

War Dog Squad

Group	Creatures
1	Two war dog sparkslingers per hero

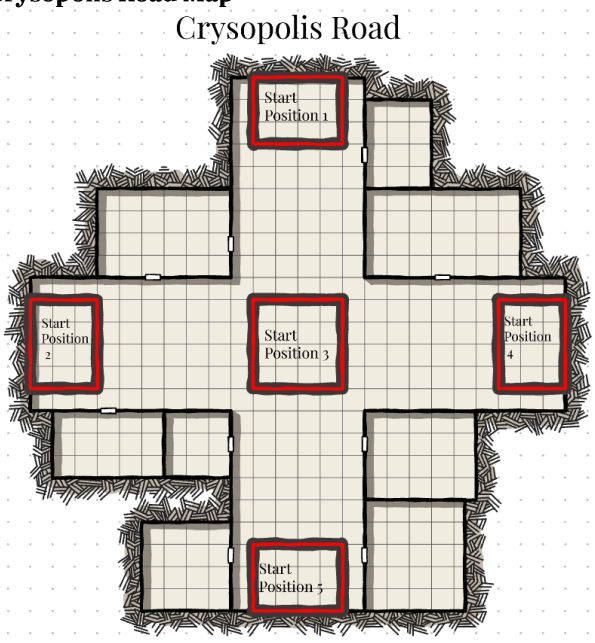
War Dog Patrol

Group	Creatures
1	One war dog equivite per character
2	Two war dog sweepers per character

War Dog Strike Team

Group	Creatures
1	One war dog hypokrite per character
2	Four war dog commandos per character, plus two extra war dog commando for each time the party previously fought a war dog strike team (minion squad)

Crysopolis Road Map



The Crysopolis Road map represents an outdoor crossroads lined with buildings. Roll on the Crysopolis Road Starting Position table to determine the start positions of the following three groups: Condemned, war dogs, and civilians (reroll if a start position is already occupied).

Crysopolis Road Starting Position

Roll (1d10)	Start Position
1–2	Start position 1
3–4	Start position 2
5–6	Start Position 3
7–8	Start Position 4
9–10	Start Position 5

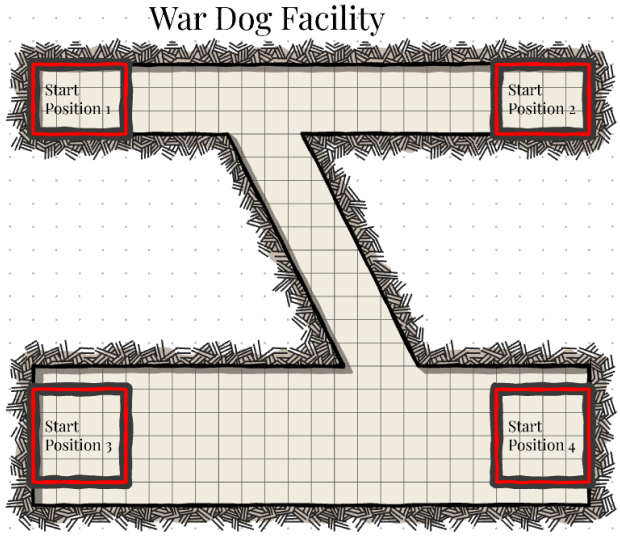
Condemned: The Condemned start in their chosen area. The encounter ends when the Condemned defeat all enemies or when they exit through any of the map's exits except the one they started in: the map edges next to Start Positions 1, 2, 4, or 5 (start position 3 is not an exit). Once a character has exited the map, they can't take turns.

Enemies: The enemies start in (or near) their chosen area. They stay in their start position until they spot the Condemned, moving to attack when they do so.

Civilians: 1d6 **noncombatants** start in their chosen area. They are too panicked to leave their spaces willingly.

Houses: The Condemned and enemies can enter the houses along the road. When the door to a house is opened for the first time, roll 1d6 and place that many noncombatants in the house.

War Dog Facility Map



The War Dog Facility map represents a section of a military base. Roll on the War Dog Facility Starting Position table to determine the start positions of the following two groups: Condemned and war dogs (reroll if a start position is already occupied).

War Dog Facility Starting Position

Roll (1d10)	Start Position
1–2	Start position 1
3–4	Start position 2
5–7	Start Position 3
8–10	Start Position 4

Condemned: The Condemned start in their chosen area. The encounter ends when the Condemned defeat all enemies or when they exit through any of the map's exits except the one they started in: the map edges next to Start Positions 1, 2, 3, or 4. Once a character has exited the map, they can't take turns.

Enemies: The enemies start in or near their chosen area and move to another area. Roll on the War Dog Facility Starting Position table to determine their destination (rerolling if their start position and destination are the same). On their turns, the war dogs move toward their destination until they spot the Condemned, attacking when they do so. If the enemies all reach their destination without spotting the Condemned, they exit the map and the encounter ends.

Director Reference: Gerold's Head

Gerold's head is alive, and has his original personality: spiteful, treacherous, greedy, and boastful.

Gerold doesn't want to fall into Ajax's hands—Ajax isn't particularly merciful to those who fail—but he also hates de Casertes' minions for reducing him to a mere head. He obeys the party's commands and answers their questions truthfully, all while keeping up a steady stream of sarcasm and insults. If the Condemned frequently insult him, he's quite willing to complicate their lives by providing incomplete information or by talking loudly at inconvenient times.

Gerold is susceptible to threats and bribes. He doesn't like being shocked, but he hates being silenced even more. He is also a wine connoisseur, especially fond of Riojan Gold (the expensive wine kept in the Abbey of Saint Iphicrates). He frequently asks for Riojan Gold or any other decent vintage. If a bottle of fine wine is poured into his valve, he briefly becomes friendly and cooperative, and may even volunteer useful information without being asked.

Interrogating Gerold

Gerold answers questions truthfully, but he never volunteers information without being asked first (until it's no longer useful). When asked specific questions, he provides the following information about the Crysopolis.

- **Questioned about ADVANCE or the asset:** "Lord Ajax has big plans for using the asset to ADVANCE his ambitions. He's codenamed it ADVANCE. Get it? He's a riot. The asset is probably somewhere in the Redoubt. I don't know where or what it is."
- **Questioned about Ajax: "**He's probably going to conquer the world, and when he does he won't be super merciful to me. He doesn't like losers. So let's stay out of his way."
- **Questioned about the Armory:** "Ajax builds war dogs there. Sure, ADVANCE could possibly be there."
- **Asked for general help:** Gerold provides some unhelpful response. Examples: "My memory is pretty short." "All this talking makes my throat sore. Could use a drink." "The plan seems pretty simple. Find the asset. Steal the asset. Steal a ship. Get caught by Ajax. End up sewed together into a single war dog."
- **Questioned about the Back Alleys, healing, or rest:** "Sleep is for the weak. I usually just get injectables in the back alleys. They really keep you going."
- **Questioned about an escape route:** "You can't teleport off the island without passwords I don't have. Might be able to steal an airship in the Redoubt."
- **Questioned about the Gambling District:** "Fun place. Fun place. Not sure how it fits in the mission but we should definitely go there."
- **Questioned about High Street, Riojan Gold, or wine:** "High Street in the Crysopolis is a great place to pick up good wine. We should head over there immediately."
- **Questioned about Khavettra (after meeting him):** "I don't know him and I don't like his stupid face."
- **Questioned about Lady Letitia (after rescuing her):** "Huh, the asset is a person, who knew?"
- **Questioned about Low Street or the Back Streets:** "That place is for manual laborers, dwarves, and other losers with no reason for living. You'll fit right in."
- **Questioned about loyalty collars or the Lower Docks:** "If you're looking to get those loyalty collars off, might find somone who knows someone in the lower docks."
- **Questioned about the Palace:** "Lord Ajax lives there. Sure, ADVANCE could possibly be there. But we should... probably not go there."
- **Asked specifically for passwords or passcodes:** "Thought you'd never ask. I know a bunch of Crysopolis passwords. " The Condemned gain 2 intel the first time they ask Gerold for this information.
- **Questioned about Record Control:** "It's the center of Ajax's spy operation. I used to go there to report to my handler. I probably can't go in there without my body though. Sure, ADVANCE could possibly be there, I guess."
- **Questioned about the Redoubt (before entering it):** "It's Ajax's fortress. Can't get in or out without the right passwords. I have some old passwords. I'm pretty sure they'll work. Pretty sure."
- **Questioned about the sewers or the Underwalks:** "The sewers do travel all over the Crysopolis, leading down to the Underwalks. We could use them to get into the Redoubt, except they're filled with murderous dwarves."
- **Questioned about the Sky Harbor:** "That's where airships dock. We should head there when we're ready to escape."
- **Questioned about UNISOL:** "I heard Ajax was making an alliance with sinister creatures from another dimension, Seems like a great idea, what could go wrong?"
- **Questioned about the teleporter (before going to the Crysopolis):** "Oh, I didn't mention this to de Caserta but it's a one-way teleporter. Can't wait to not see his face when he realizes. We'll need to find another escape route when we're done with the mission." If informed of this, De Caserta is furious but still goes ahead with the mission.